

International Bartenders Association

A GUIDE TO SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY

International Bartenders Association A GUIDE TO SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY





A GUIDE TO SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY



The work of the barman is part of a long and distinguished tradition. The professional figure of a person skilled in preparing cocktails first emerged in the US in the twentieth century, during the Second World War. It was then that the American named Jerry Thomas - “The Professor” - drew up a code of professional standards and cocktail recipes in his book “How to Mix Drinks”, which was published in 1962. The barman came into being.

At the global level, the reference organisation for the bartending profession is the International Bartenders Association (IBA). It is a federation comprised of the barmen trade associations of 52 countries with more than 40,000 members working on all five continents.





WORKBOOK CONTENTS	page
Introduction	1
Module A	
Alcohol, its origins and role in society	9
Module B	
The Bartender, role and responsibilities	23
Module C	
The Consumer and other associated problems with alcohol	43
Module D	
Management, People Skills	49
Module E	
Policy Issues	63
 Appendices	 73
 References and Acknowledgements	 80

This booklet is published by the International Bartenders Association (“IBA”). The views expressed within are those of the IBA, and should not be attributed to any single member. This booklet is intended as a teaching aid, does not constitute medical or legal advice and is not intended for use as an employee handbook or similar document.



A Welcome Message

Alcoholic beverages are popular drinks consumed when socialising, entertaining, and networking. Enjoying a beverage enlivens our moment of relaxation and promotes healthy geniality when consumed. However, over indulgence of alcohol may bring harmful consequences. Alcohol is so ubiquitous that we almost forget that it should be treated carefully and to serve it with care. When it comes to exercising duty of care, commercial providers of alcohol must continually educate and train staff on responsible beverage service.

An ongoing program that educates staff and reinforces the issues in every alcohol-serving establishment can reduce service-related alcohol problems. After all, prevention is the best defence.

This workbook provides bar owners, bartenders and beverage servers at all levels with the knowledge necessary to meet their responsibilities, including eliminating the sale and service of liquor to minors and reducing over-consumption of alcohol in licensed establishments. Within these pages, you will find some useful practical information about serving alcohol responsibly.

Go through all assignments and exercises diligently. You will find the structured learning process useful. The IBA has trained facilitators within IBA guild countries to guide you through this course.

The IBA is grateful to Bacardi Limited for providing financial resources towards the production of this book.

Cheers!

Derrick Lee
IBA President



Message from Bacardi



Andreas Gembler
*President & Chief
Executive Officer
Bacardi Limited*

At the 2006 General Assembly of the International Bartenders association, Bacardi Limited sponsored the book “Moderation and Responsibility” to promote in co-operation with the IBA, the importance of social responsibility and responsible serving to IBA’s member organisations.

We are now pleased to follow up our support by sponsoring this Training Manual on Responsible Serving and Social Responsibility. This training aid is the next step in our partnership to bring more help to this key business area where raising standards will benefit your customers and our consumers.

Bacardi Limited has a long tradition in cocktail making, understands the business benefits of serving consumers well, and is committed to promoting responsible drinking. Bartenders play a vital role in supporting this tradition and can make a real difference to consumer behaviours by encouraging them to enjoy drinks in a responsible manner.

Our Marketing companies round the world are working closely to develop our brands through top premium bars. This training manual highlights the importance of social responsibility as an integral part of bartending skills and Bacardi Limited is delighted to welcome this new book as part of our ambition to demonstrate leadership in the field of social responsibility.

We support and applaud the IBA for taking on this challenge to show leadership in this important area of its profession. Enhancing the quality of its members work in all aspects of bartending training and putting the discipline of social responsibility as part of the routine should be encouraged by all of us.

We trust that this book will be welcomed and used by all of the IBA membership and that this investment will prove to be another rewarding partnership between our two organisations.

Andreas Gembler
*President & Chief Executive Officer
Bacardi Limited*

Message from: The Educational Development Committee

Our Strategic Direction: Social Responsibility Program

We believed the most urgent item was to form a comprehensive strategy that would be sound and workable for all countries concerned, both for the present and the future, with an opportunity for additions and updates.

Some of the information was already out in the public area in one form or another, so our job was to choose and compile an appropriate text that would be suitable for all I.B.A. Guilds and Associations.

This gave us a clear and definitive objective for this project development, in line with IBA and Associate members policy regarding education of beverage service staff.

Proposed Outcomes

We now believe we have developed a clear and concise path of study for all concerned that will be both educational, rewarding and meets the above stated objectives of the EDC Committee. Whilst this may take a little time to reach fruition, there will be an interim measure that will be instigated to meet short term objectives. It is the overall objective of the EDC Committee that this course is delivered in all IBA member countries and meets their own legislative controls.

Course Pre-requisites

Entry requirement to this scheme is through National Bartender Associations affiliated to the IBA.

EDC Chairman:	Jorge Moniz Pereira	EDC Europe
EDC Secretary:	Albert Ong	
Committee:	Larry Naylor	EDC Southern Hemisphere
	Hidetsugu Ueno	EDC Far East
	Pedro Medina Borges	EDC North America
	Nepomuceno Gonzalez	EDC South America



Mr Jorge Moniz Pereira
EDC Chairman







MODULE A

Alcohol, its origins and role in society

Topics Covered

- ♦ The origins of alcohol
- ♦ Alcohol and the world's economies
- ♦ What is alcohol?
- ♦ How is it made?
- ♦ The chemistry of alcohol
- ♦ When alcohol enters the body
- ♦ How alcohol leaves the body
- ♦ What is aldehyde dehydrogenase?
- ♦ Alcohol today
- ♦ The general effects of alcohol
- ♦ How the body responds to alcohol
- ♦ How alcohol affects the body's system
- ♦ Importance of alcohol in moderation
- ♦ Alcohol education

The origins of alcohol

The production of alcoholic beverages dates back to the late Stone Ages, the Neolithic period. It has been suggested that beer might have even preceded bread as a staple diet. A pictograph of wine appears in Egypt from around 4,000 B.C. Evidence points to alcohol in wine jars from Jiahu, China from as early as 7000 B.C. In India, alcoholic beverages in the Indus valley civilization appeared in the Chalcolithic Era – 3000 B.C.-2000 B.C.

All ancient cultures had their own form of alcohol, and it played its own role in each society, be it religious or cultural.

Alcohol and the world's economies

The profound positive effect that the alcoholic beverage industry has on world markets cannot be denied.

Alcohol is a vital trading commodity in the world economy. From the production, to the marketing, distribution, to the sale of alcohol, the economic influence is vast.

The alcoholic beverage industry relies on its suppliers of raw materials, be it farmers producing barley, hops, wheat and maize for the production of beer, to the vineyard owners who grow the grapes for making wine and brandy. Also key are the producers of other raw materials such as sugar cane for making rum, fruit, herbs and spices for flavouring wines and spirits and liqueurs. Producers also grow apples for cider and apple brandy guava are grown for the production of Tequila and Mezcal.



Then there's the equipment associated with the production of alcohol. Stills, fermentation and storage tanks, stainless steel mash urns, condensing and pasteurizing equipment, pumps, harvesters all need to be purchased and maintained.

The alcoholic liquid will need to be placed in containers of some sort. Bottles, corks, caps, cases, pallets, glassware of all types, beer dispensing equipment and its installation and maintenance, beer kegs, barrels/casks, cocktail shakers and other equipment, measuring devices and cooling units, refrigerators ice machines are another industry altogether.

There's also logistics involved. In its initial stages, the raw materials need to be transported to processing plants. Once the alcoholic beverage is made, it needs to be stored and moved again, this time to its packaging plants, then to its distributors. In its port of entry, it will have to clear customs, be distributed to wholesalers and then to the retail outlets where it finally reaches the customer.

So who transports the alcohol? The personnel that operate the lorries, tankers, trains, ships, airlines, forklift trucks all move all the alcohol across the world.

Governments too, get rewarded. Governments benefit from Duties and VAT that are assessed and imposed on the alcohol. Also indirectly, taxes from salaries of all those involved in the production and distribution of the drinks industry boost the GDP.

The industry employs a huge number of personnel indirectly. Job sustenance also includes the manufacturers of the finished items, those who package, store, distribute, market the items, and sell it. Support is also provided from secretaries, clerks, advertising specialists, accountants, architects, designers, builders and furniture manufacturers, just to name a handful.

Other front-line employees include bartenders, hoteliers, restaurateurs, club staff, cellar men, off-license staff, cleaners. They too, owe their livelihood to this industry.



What is Alcohol?

The nature of 100% alcohol as a chemical is such

- ♦ it's a clear liquid at room temperature
- ♦ its properties allow it to be distilled as alcohol, because it is less dense and evaporates at a lower temperature than water
- ♦ it dissolves easily in water
- ♦ it is so flammable, it can be used as a fuel

How is Alcohol made?

It is made by fermentation. Carbohydrate-containing plant materials are allowed to ferment, producing a dilute solution of ethanol in the process. Ethanol is the only potable alcohol safe for human consumption. The dilute solution can be separated by distillation, thus achieving a higher concentration level of alcohol, known as hard liquors or spirits.

Fermentation – Ethanol fermentation is responsible for the rising of bread dough and the production of ethanol in alcoholic beverages. Yeasts in (or introduced to) grain or fruit juices, and mixes, convert sugars such as glucose, fructose, and sucrose, into ethanol and carbon dioxide. The result is a dilute solution of ethanol.

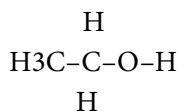
Distillation - This is a method of separating chemical substances based on differences in their volatilities in a boiling liquid mixture. Spirits such as whiskey and rum are prepared by distilling these dilute solutions of ethanol. Other components than ethanol are collected in the condensate, including water, esters, and other alcohols which account for the flavour of the beverage.

Definition - A distilled beverage is thus a consumable liquid containing ethyl alcohol (ethanol) purified by distillation from a fermented substance such as fruit, vegetables, or grain. The word spirits generally refers to distilled beverages low in sugars and containing at least 35% alcohol by volume. Absinthe, baijiu, brandy, gin, ginger wine, rum, tequila, vodka, whisky, and traditional German schnapps are types of spirits. Distilled beverages with added flavourings and a relatively high sugar content such as Grand Marnier, Frangelico and American style schnapps are generally referred to as liqueurs. The term liquor may mean spirits; spirits and liqueurs; or all alcoholic beverages, including wine, sake, beer, and mead.

The chemistry of Alcohol

The word “alcohol” is derived from the Arabic word ‘al-kuhl’.

The alcohol found in alcoholic beverages is ethyl alcohol (ethanol). Its molecular formula is variously represented as EtOH, CH₃CH₂OH, C₂H₅OH or as its empirical formula C₂H₆O. Based on its abilities to change the human consciousness, alcohol is considered a drug.



C is the carbon, H hydrogen and O Oxygen atoms. The hyphens in between them are chemical bonds. The O–H group on the molecule is what gives alcohol its specific properties.

Pure alcohol (ethanol) cannot exist in drinking form. It is deadly, as it only takes a few ounces to raise one’s blood alcohol concentration levels into the danger limits. Below you will find some idea of ethanol concentration in various types of beverages

- ♦ Beer = 4 to 6% (average of 4.5%)
- ♦ Wine = 7 to 15% (average of 11%)
- ♦ Champagne = 8 to 14% (average of 12%)
- ♦ Distilled spirits (eg, rum, gin vodka whisky) = 40 – 95%

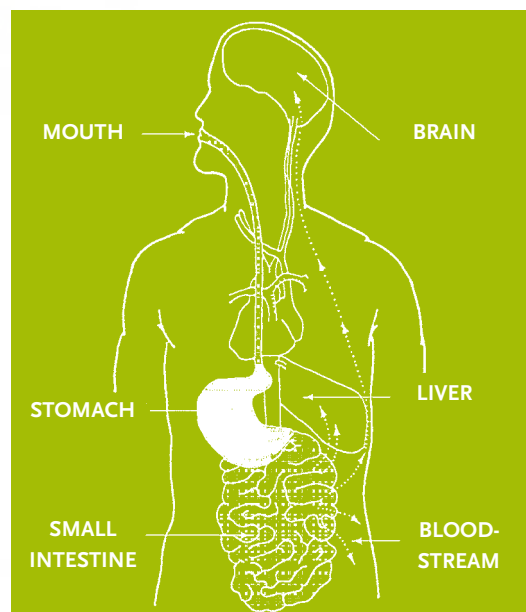
What happens when alcohol enters your body

20% of the alcohol is absorbed by the body and the rest, 80% is absorbed by the small intestine.

How fast the alcohol is absorbed depends on several factors

- ♦ the alcohol concentration in the beverage (the higher the concentration, the faster the absorption.)
- ♦ what type of drink it is (carbonated drinks speed up the absorption)
- ♦ is your stomach full or empty? (food slows down alcohol absorption)

After absorption, the alcohol enters the blood stream. Blood then carries it throughout the body. The alcohol from the blood enters and dissolves in the water inside each tissue of the body (with the exception of fat tissue, as alcohol cannot dissolve in fat). This is when one will start showing the effects of alcohol in the body – the blood alcohol concentration (BAC). The BAC will rise significantly 20 minutes after having a drink.



How alcohol leaves the body

Once absorbed by the blood stream, it leaves the body in 3 ways:

- ♦ the kidney eliminates 5% of the alcohol in the urine
- ♦ the lungs expel 5% of alcohol (hence the use of breathalyzer devices)
- ♦ the liver oxidizes and breaks down the alcohol into water and carbon dioxide.

Very generally, an average person can eliminate 0.5 oz (15ml) of alcohol per hour. So it would take about an hour to get rid of alcohol from a 12oz (355ml) can of beer.

It's important to note however that, the BAC increases when the body absorbs alcohol faster than when it can eliminate it. The body can only eliminate about one dose of alcohol per hour, by drinking several drinks in that time will increase your BAC much more than having one drink over an hour or more.

What is aldehyde dehydrogenase?

They are a group of enzymes that occur in many organisms and facilitate the inter-conversion between alcohols and aldehydes and ketones. They essentially break down alcohols that would otherwise be toxic. These enzymes are contained in the lining of the stomach and the liver. Aldehyde dehydrogenase catalyzes the oxidation of ethanol to acetaldehyde.

It has been found that 50% of people of Asian decent possess an atypical alcohol dehydrogenase (ADH) that leads to unusually rapid conversion of ethanol to acetaldehyde. Since acetaldehyde is more toxic than alcohol, its increased accumulation causes flushing in the body. Normal aldehyde dehydrogenase, synthesized in the liver, oxidizes acetaldehyde into a carboxylic acid, acetic acid.

Between 45 to 53% of Japanese, Chinese, Korean, Taiwanese and Vietnamese possess a mutated enzyme that is only 8% as effective as the normal enzyme. This means this group of people is much more sensitive to alcohol due to this condition. After consuming one or two drinks, the following symptoms might occur – flushing or blushing, erythema (reddening caused by dilation of the capillaries) of the neck, face and shoulder, increased pulse, dizziness, skin itchiness and swelling.

These symptoms may thus be misinterpreted as signs that these people are more easily inebriated, which is not the case.

Alcohol today

Today, alcohol is considered society's most prevalent and accepted legal recreational drug.

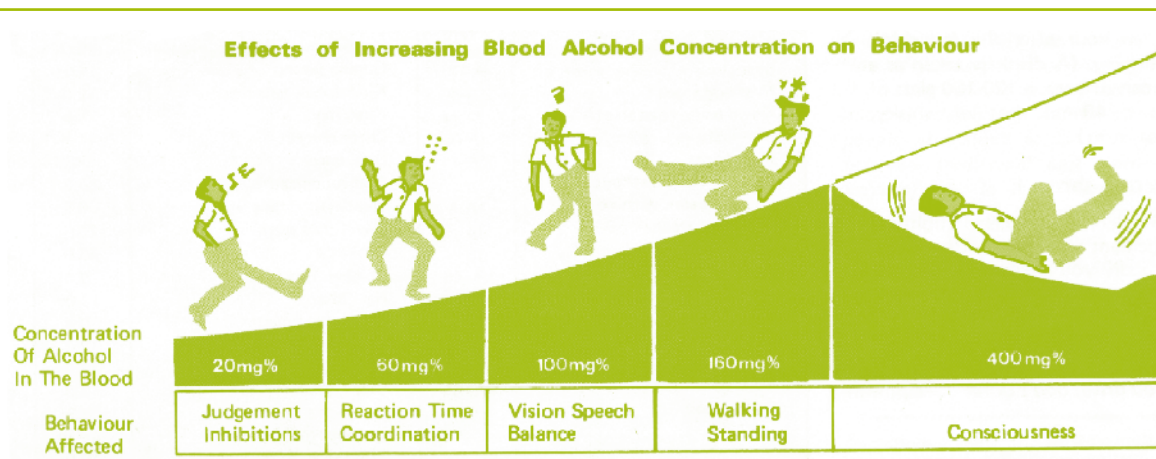
Alcohol is part and parcel of daily life. Adults celebrate, relax and commiserate with it. Alcohol is used in cooking and even in religious rituals. The vast majority of drinkers the world over are the occasional/moderate type who recognize their limits and enjoy the odd drink now and then.

However, there are the small minority of heavy/excessive drinkers who abuse their alcohol tolerance and for them, alcohol is a problem. Alcoholics fall into this category. Often, their drinking also becomes a societal problem, as long-term abuse leads to the disintegration of family, professional and societal units. The costs to remedy and rehabilitate these individuals comes at a hefty price – economically and emotionally.

In the United States alone, the health and welfare services provided to alcoholics and their families amount, to billions of dollars. That's not counting the economic revenue lost from employees calling in sick after a night's bout of drinking or individuals who have lost their jobs due to their alcohol addiction.

The general effects of alcohol

Alcohol acts on the brain as an anaesthetic, sedative, and stimulant, depending on how much of it is consumed. The effects of alcohol are more prevalent when more alcohol is consumed and corresponds to one's blood alcohol concentration (BAC).



1. Euphoria (BAC = 0.03 to 0.12%)

- ♦ one becomes more self-confident or daring
- ♦ attention span shortens
- ♦ judgment is affected
- ♦ writing and other skills are affected

2. Excitement (BAC = 0.09 to 0.25%)

- ♦ sleepiness
- ♦ difficulty recalling recent events/remembering things
- ♦ reaction time is slowed/uncoordinated
- ♦ vision gets blurred
- ♦ dullness of sensory organs

3. Confusion (BAC = 0.18 to 0.30%)

- ♦ confusion sets in
- ♦ dizziness and unsteady gait
- ♦ emotions kick into higher gear, possible overly aggressive or sentimental reactions
- ♦ sight, speech and coordination are affected
- ♦ may experience higher pain threshold

4. Stupor (BAC = 0.25 to 0.4%)

- ♦ inability to walk, stand or move unassisted
- ♦ vomiting
- ♦ lapsing in and out of consciousness

5. Coma (BAC = 0.35 to 0.50%)

- ♦ unconsciousness
- ♦ reflexes are depressed (ie, pupils do not respond to light)
- ♦ body temperature drops
- ♦ breathing is slower and more shallow, heart rate drops
- ♦ risk of death

6. Death (BAC more than 0.50%)

How the body responds to alcohol

Alcohol interferes with communication between nerve cells and all other cells, suppressing the activities of excitatory nerve pathways and increasing the activities of inhibitory nerve pathways. Alcohol affects various centres in the higher and lower orders of the brain. The centres are not equally affected by the same BAC. The higher orders are more sensitive than the lower order centres.

As the BAC increases, the more centres of the brain are affected.

The order in which alcohol affects the various brain centres are:

1. Cerebral cortex (processes information from your senses, does your 'thought' processing and consciousness)
2. Limbic system (controls emotions and memory)
3. Cerebellum (coordinates the movement of muscles and balance)
4. Hypothalamus and pituitary gland (controls and influences many automatic functions of the brain. Urine secretion is also controlled by the pituitary gland)
5. Medulla or brain stem (controls breathing, heart rate, temperature and consciousness)

How alcohol effects the body systems

In addition to affecting the brain, alcohol affects the body's tissues in the following manner

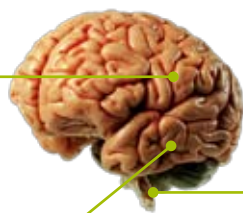
- ♦ Linings of the stomach and intestines are irritated (hence vomiting)
- ♦ Blood flow increases to the stomach and intestines (stomach acid secretion occurs)
- ♦ Blood circulation to the skin is increased (a person can look flushed or sweat, their body temperature can also drop)
- ♦ Blood flow to the muscles is reduced (hence muscle aches, notably when a person recovers from the alcohol – the hangover)

All of the alcohol's effects continue until the ingested alcohol is eliminated from the body.

Forebrain

Centre for uniquely human qualities

- ♦ *the higher functions:*
- ♦ *Judgement*
- ♦ *Decision making*
- ♦ *Problem solving*
- ♦ *Social codes*
- ♦ *Mood*
- ♦ *Confidence*



Midbrain and cerebellum

Centre for co-ordination of senses and actions:

- ♦ *Co-ordination of muscles including those for posture, balance and speech*
- ♦ *Processing of information from senses, including vision, hearing, pain*
- ♦ *Responsiveness*

Hindbrain

Centre for control of basic life functions:

- ♦ *Reflexes*
- ♦ *Body temprature*
- ♦ *Heart rate*
- ♦ *Breathing*

Increasing BAC →

Factors that influence the effect alcohol has on the body

Men and Women

It is important to understand that alcohol's effects are different for men and women. In general, men are able to drink more alcohol before they feel its effects. This has to do with their larger overall body size, as well as with the fact that more of a woman's body is made up of fat more easily. As a result, since alcohol dissolves in fat, it reaches higher concentrations more quickly in the bodies of women than in those of men. It also has to do, as we have mentioned already, with the difference in enzymes (dehydrogenase) that break down ethanol in the body and help eliminate it from the system.

This means that women may feel the primary effects of alcohol more quickly. For example, they may become "tipsy" sooner. It also means that in women, it may take less alcohol to harm their bodies than it takes men to do the same amount of harm.

Age makes a difference

Older people become more susceptible to the effects of alcohol because of their decreased ability to break it down. In addition, they are more likely to be in poor health and taking medications than younger people, making them more sensitive to the effects of alcohol.

Young adults are also more sensitive to alcohol, especially when it comes to harm. There are a number of reasons for this. For example, young people are generally inexperienced drinkers and are prone to taking more risks than older adults. The physiology of young adults and the developmental changes taking place within their brains and other organs also increases their risk for harm. Young adults may not be fully aware of the effect that alcohol has on them and are generally less sensitive to the symptoms of intoxication. At the same time, alcohol and its by-products may have a greater harmful effect on their bodies.

Is your stomach full or empty?

How quickly alcohol acts also depends on whether an individual is eating while drinking or is drinking on an empty stomach. Food slows down the absorption of alcohol from the "gut" into the blood stream, slowing down its effects and slowing down intoxication.

For that reason, it is generally recommended that drinking be accompanied with food, if not before.

When to avoid alcohol

Alcohol may interact with some medications. In some cases, as with certain antibiotics, it may render them less effective. In other instances, alcohol may dangerously change the effects of certain medications, especially those that act on the central nervous system.

Alcohol is likely to have quite different effects on different individuals and for some people, not drinking at all may be advisable. These include people who are unable

to metabolize alcohol easily, people with a family history of alcohol dependence (or alcoholism), and individuals who have trouble controlling the amount they drink.

Pregnant women may also be at risk from drinking due, to potential damage to the fetus. They should avoid alcohol, even at the earliest stages of pregnancy.

The Importance of Alcohol in Moderation

Responsible drinking

What exactly is 'safe drinking?' Everyone's physiology differs, and so one's tolerance to alcohol varies. Medical journals recognise the merits of alcohol in your diet, but exactly how much is good for you? And when does it become detrimental?

"An understanding of the risks and benefits associated with alcohol consumption is an important tool for preventing harm."

Why alcohol education is so important

Informing and educating the general population about the risks of alcohol abuse is vital in any society, since it is so much part of one's daily life.

Educational programs take many forms and vary in their effectiveness. Some target raising awareness, others bring about behavioural change. Successful approaches to alcohol education depend on clearly defined goals and outcomes, should be culturally appropriate and sensitive, and need to be realistically achievable and relevant to a particular culture or community.

Much of what we know about alcohol, how we view drinking, and whether we make the decision to drink is the result of an informal process that involves learning through personal experience and is largely shaped by culture.

For policy and prevention in your premise, it is important to view alcohol education as one of several elements needed to reduce the risk of harm. While it may not offer all the solutions, alcohol education is an integral component of wide-ranging and balanced policies and prevention measures.

Alcohol education

The aim of alcohol education is twofold:

- ♦ to raise awareness and share knowledge and skills that will enable consumers to make healthy and informed choices about their drinking
- ♦ to help those who choose to drink to avoid patterns that are associated with health and social harm to themselves and others

Educating individuals at risk

Young adults of Legal Drinking Age - The developmental changes that occur in adolescence, young people's general propensity for risk taking, and their relative inexperience with alcohol place them at heightened risk for harm.

Special educational approaches also need to be developed for other populations for whom risk or harm may be increased due to their social status, personal characteristics, or behaviours and drinking patterns.

Educating the general public

Alcohol education is also relevant to the public at large. This includes information about low risk drinking through guidelines and recommendations, basic facts about the effects of alcohol, and information that can help individuals avoid harmful drinking patterns and situations. Such education also includes specific information for men and for women about the effects of alcohol consumption on each gender.

While these approaches may not always result in behavioural change, they are considered necessary in informing individuals and equipping them to make decisions about their own drinking.

The provision of accurate information about alcohol can include balanced information about drinking patterns and outcomes, including health and social implications. Creating awareness about drinking guidelines and recommendations is an important part of alcohol education.

Other goals also include creating awareness among the broad public about the regulations that exist around alcohol, within a given country or jurisdiction.

Aspects pertinent to responsible use of alcohol

- ♦ age of legal consumption and purchase
- ♦ availability, hours of operation
- ♦ alcohol in the workplace
- ♦ drinking and driving regulations

Last Word on Alcohol Education

To have its intended impact, alcohol education, like any other policy measure, must be culturally sensitive and appropriate. It should reflect a community's culture, attitudes, and needs and be pragmatic and realistic both in its goals and approaches. It would seem unachievable (and unwarranted), for example, to develop policies to promote prohibition where alcohol is deeply embedded into a society's culture. At the same time, it is important to educate people about making personal choices, whether these involve drinking or abstinence.

These are some of the questions we have addressed and we sincerely hope this module will help you make more informed decisions during your bartending career.



Self Assessment Questions:

A. Name the important enzyme in the body that converts alcohol.

B. Besides food that slows down the absorption of alcohol from the “gut” into the blood stream, what other factors influence the effect alcohol has on the body.

C. How does alcohol leave the body





MODULE B

Bartenders, role and responsibilities

Topics Covered

- ♦ Social Responsibility
- ♦ The Bartender's Role & the Importance of Social Responsibility for the Barman
- ♦ The 'Social Responsibility Strategy' or how to serve alcohol responsibly
- ♦ Signs of Intoxication
- ♦ Service and the High Risk Customer
- ♦ Bartenders and alcohol
- ♦ Alcohol and its role in society
- ♦ Alcohol, lifestyles and tolerance
- ♦ Alcoholic drinks – strength and pouring measures
- ♦ Standard Alcohol Units
- ♦ International Drinking Guidelines

Social Responsibility

This is the term that applies to the professional practice of caring for customers and patrons in various premises. This could include an up-market cocktail bar or the pub/tavern on the corner and even a restaurant and a nightclub. Servers are responsible for ensuring that alcohol is consumed with care by customers / patrons, and in most countries this is enforced by law.

There is a general perception that alcohol can be a “Social Lubricant”, but harm may result from overindulgence and irresponsible behaviour by those who, on becoming intoxicated, believe they are “ten feet tall and bullet proof”.

Bartenders have the task of serving and communicating with all types of people from all walks of life and strata of society, with different cultural backgrounds. Whilst in the main bartending is an enjoyable and rewarding job, there are many occasions when it can be one of the most difficult to perform.

Difficulties arise when customers have consumed too much alcohol. This situation requires considerable patience, tact, firmness and above all experience when handling difficult situations that may have arisen because of overindulgence on the part of one or more customers.

Servers of alcohol have to use all of their senses at all times - their powers of observation, memory, and alertness - each is vital in ensuring the success of the hospitality business.



“Drink-drive regulations around the world set Blood Alcohol Concentration levels, ranging from 0.1 to 0.8 grams per litre of blood”.

The Bartender's Role & the Importance of Social Responsibility for the Barman

Bartenders are expected to play many roles. They include being:

- ♦ a “good host” helping to create a friendly atmosphere
- ♦ a “sales person” knowledgeable about your products
- ♦ a “safety officer” thinking about the well being of customers and reducing any risks
- ♦ a “police officer” ensuring no one breaks any laws
- ♦ a “cleaner”, making sure premises are clean and tidy

Bartenders and all members of staff within the hospitality and retail industries also need to appreciate and understand their responsibilities relating to alcohol, to appreciate how alcohol affects the body, and weigh the benefits and risks associated with alcohol consumption.

The barman is a professional server of alcoholic beverages. The barman has a responsibility to satisfy the customer, but more importantly a responsibility to serve alcoholic beverages in a responsible manner. If a barman considers a customer has consumed too much alcohol, then the barman has a responsibility to intervene firmly at an opportune moment and stop serving the customer. This approach is particularly important, as it is illegal to serve alcohol to any person under the legal drinking age.

Selling alcohol requires many skills and involves legal responsibilities. The laws of your country must be followed. You also need to be aware of your social responsibilities - that is the things you should do to run a good business and have a positive impact on your community.





The 'Social Responsibility Strategy' or how to serve alcohol responsibly

Here are some things you can do to serve alcohol responsibly.

Provide Food

Serving food at your establishment/premises helps prevent problems in two ways:

- ♦ it slows the absorption of alcohol into the bloodstream;
- ♦ when customers are eating, they are likely to drink less.

Some establishments offer free snacks around meal times. Besides, customers appreciate well-priced, interesting snacks.

Customers who drop in after work are likely to have an empty stomach.

Sales techniques can achieve both profitability and social responsibility goals

You may have chosen the route of bulk sales (e.g. the use of jugs) to increase turnover. In such a case, promoting drinks with juices is an example where the social responsibility goal can be met at the same time.

To prevent customers from becoming intoxicated, you could use differential pricing to encourage customers to drink in moderation. In other words, stronger drinks are priced higher than drinks that are lighter in alcohol.

Providing choices translates into good customer service.

Anticipate and be alert to customer behaviour

Some customers come to a bar with the intention of getting intoxicated or drunk, particularly when they are celebrating an event such as birthday parties, 'stag' or 'hen' parties. At other times, they could be engaged in a drinking competition or game, each patron trying to outdo the others in the amount of drink consumed. Such events must be properly monitored and controlled.

Be aware of customers who take advantage of special offers to the extreme, thus drinking too much in too short a time.

Problems can occur also when groups buy their drinks in rounds by establishing a 'kitty' or pool of money. Whilst it seems that you are selling more, the result usually leads to difficulties arising from intoxication.

Binge Drinking – Recognising the signs

Some people drink very heavily within a short period of time on certain occasions. This is typically called binge drinking.

People who “binge drink” become drunk quite quickly and may lose control quite rapidly, as well. Binge drinking can be defined for:

Males : Between 5-6 drinks in a single session

Females : Between 4-5 drinks in a single session

A good bartender will monitor alcohol consumption and patterns of drinking of his/her customers, so that potential trouble can be predicted well in advance and appropriate steps can be taken to prevent it.

Customers can be intoxicated very soon after arrival in your bar, if they have been drinking elsewhere before entering your premises (e.g. prior drinking at home).

Service Checklist for Bartenders

Do not serve anyone who is not legally entitled; check the minimum age in your country.

Recognise intoxication and avoid serving anyone to the point of obvious Intoxication.

Refuse to serve anyone who is already intoxicated.

Discourage customers from taking part in activities that may cause harm.

Aspects of Welfare

The good barman considers the welfare of his/her customers. It is therefore essential that you are alert to any possible dangers that may be present. Welfare begins with simply ensuring customers are comfortable and feel secure.

Emergency evacuation - Ensure that you are familiar with all the policies and procedures with regard to evacuation procedures in the event of a fire, flooding, bomb alert, or sudden violence taking place. Be aware of the quickest and safest route to an exit. Emergency exits should not be blocked or locked. Proprietors should conduct regular evacuation practices of the premises.

Environment - It is important to maintain a pleasant ambience by ensuring the sound levels, cleanliness, ventilation, temperature, and lighting, are at the appropriate levels.



Signs of Intoxication

When a person is beginning to get intoxicated, he/she is

- 1 *Drinking too fast*
- 2 *Careless with money on the bar or at tables*
- 3 *Complaining about drink prices*
- 4 *Complaining about drink strength or the preparation*
- 5 *Overly friendly to customers or employees*
- 6 *Annoying other customers*
- 7 *Losing train of thought or concentration*
- 8 *Letting a cigarette burn without smoking it*
- 9 *Becoming detached or brooding*
- 10 *Making too many comments about others in the establishment*

The person is already intoxicated when he/she shows the following

- 1 *Drowsiness.*
- 2 *Loud, argumentative, mean or obnoxious behaviour in conversation*
- 3 *Entertaining, animated or boisterous behaviour*
- 4 *Spilling all or part of a drink*
- 5 *Altered speech pattern*
- 6 *Slurred speech*
- 7 *Losing eye contact, unable to focus*
- 8 *Difficulty in lighting a cigarette*
- 9 *Loss of muscle control and clumsiness*
- 10 *Changes in walk, stumbling*
- 11 *Bumping into or knocking over furniture*

Responsible service to customers

It is a fine balance to ensure that customers enjoy your products and services, but not become too intoxicated, or cause disturbances to others in your bar while at the same time, causing damage to their health and risking their safety.

Responsible bar service requires great diplomacy and patience to ensure that intoxicated customers are aware of the discomfort they may be causing others.

Therefore, creating a friendly ambience at the bar is important so that you can secure the assistance of others in the group to help control one or two that may be causing problems. Often a quiet word in the ear of a sober friend of the customers(s) is sufficient to calm what otherwise may be a stormy situation.

Remember, you need to be polite but firm when dealing with intoxicated customers, as they can be unpredictable. It is important that you and your colleagues work as a team and that everyone is alert and aware of the possible difficulties that may arise.

If it looks as if a situation may be getting out of control, assistance from door-men or managers should be called for well in advance.

Above all, don't try to handle a difficult situation if you are not confident and have very little experience.

Service communication- Be aware of cultural differences and be respectful of this at all times. There are many ways to communicate with customers. You can be passive, and put other people's needs and wants ahead of your own. You can be aggressive, and demand your needs and wants be satisfied before any others. Or you can be assertive, express your needs and wants while at the same time respecting the needs and wants of others.

Service & the High Risk Customer – using a Risk Rating System

The Risk Rating System, allows you to control how much alcohol your customers consume using a grading scale - Low Risk, Medium Risk (beginning to get intoxicated) , or High Risk (already intoxicated). Once you have determined the risk level, appropriate action may be taken, related to the grade.

How it works

Empowerment – Servers/barmen are empowered to “put on the brakes” and stop service. For example, for a guest with a medium risk rating, when the guest has reached his/her maximum number of drinks, service can be delayed for at least one hour; If the high risk rating is due to the customer showing signs of intoxication, service of alcohol may be terminated for the duration of the evening.

High Risk can be easily determined by a customer's actions, (see Signs of Intoxication), and various factors such as - entering the premises incorrectly or because they are a minor.

How to delay or suspend service

Always get backup from security before initiating a one hour delay, or terminating alcohol service.

Be assertive in dealing with the guest but always remain polite. Try not to back the customer into a corner. “We can lose our license if I serve you any more alcohol.”

Use a non-judgmental approach; you want them back again sometime in the future. *Do not judge or appear to judge by using emotionally charged words such as “drunk”, “high”, or “you’ve had too much”.*

Be friendly, kind and considerate, yet firm. Do not debate your decision. Make the statement and walk away. It's hard for the customer to argue if you're not there.



Explain establishment policy and use non-judgemental statements

"I'm sorry, but if I served you another drink I'd lose my job."

"I've served you all that I can."

Once service is delayed or terminated, do not back down or change your mind.

Alert management of the potential problem. If a problem arises, let security or management handle it. Be prepared to call security or the police if necessary.

Always communicate that the policies are there for the guest's benefit and that you are personally concerned for the guest's well being. *"I'm sorry, but it's against the law for me to serve you any more alcohol."*

Try to keep the guest from leaving, especially if he or she is driving.

Instead, suggest an alternative form of transportation for the customer:

- ♦ ask his ' friends to drive him/her home;
- ♦ offer to call a cab; offer to call a friend or family member;
- ♦ try to enlist the help of a companion of the guest's, in seeing to it that he or she gets home safely. Also make sure that the patron has his / her personal belongings.

Serving alcohol to a person who is already intoxicated is also an offence in most countries. Once someone has consumed alcohol to a level that they are showing signs of drunkenness, their normal judgement is impaired. Therefore, it is up to the server, not the customer, to decide whether they should be served or not.

Bartenders and alcohol

Bartenders and those employed in the hospitality and drinks industries are at far higher risk of having alcohol related problems, compared with the 'normal' population. This is because their workplace serves alcohol and it is within easy reach.

For those who drink, alcohol is something to be enjoyed. Most of the time, drinking doesn't cause any problems but drinking too much or at the wrong time can be harmful. The important thing is to know where the benefits end and the risks begin.

Indulge moderately

Use alcohol for enjoyment, at a party, for relaxation, with food, as part of a dish, to unwind at the weekend.

There are some occasions when it makes sense to drink less than other days, or not to drink at all.

Women who are trying to become pregnant or are at any stage of pregnancy should either preferably not drink at all or in any event not drink more than 1 or 2 units of

alcohol once or twice a week, and avoid episodes of intoxication completely. (See end of this module to determine 'units' of alcohol.)

Individuals are advised not to drink at all:

- ◆ Before or when driving (Legal implications)
- ◆ Before or when operating machinery, electrical equipment, using ladders or working at heights (Risk of injury)
- ◆ When it might affect the quality of work
- ◆ Before swimming or taking part in an active sport (Risk of injury)
- ◆ Before or when taking certain medicines (Risk or adverse reactions)
- ◆ If a doctor or other health professional advises you not to drink.
- ◆ If pregnant or trying to conceive.

Medium term effects of over indulgence

- ◆ A variety of serious illnesses is caused through overindulgence.
- ◆ Loss of earnings through absenteeism, lateness or loss of job.
- ◆ Financial difficulties due to spending so much on the purchase of alcohol.
- ◆ Involvement in crime, e.g. causing a nuisance, football hooliganism
- ◆ Loss of license through drinking and driving offences.
- ◆ Consequences of drunk driving such as seriously injuring/killing others
- ◆ Loss of self-esteem / confidence.
- ◆ Imprisonment or police record.
- ◆ Loss of home / family and friends.
- ◆ Risk of being the victim of a crime.
- ◆ Injury as a result of falling or being involved in a fight.
- ◆ Increased risk of accident at work and at home.
- ◆ Branded as a drunk

Safe and responsible drinking

Alcohol is a depressant - While the initial effect of alcohol is to help reduce inhibitions and to help get a party off to a good start, its effects can vary in each individual addictive.

Alcohol's effect takes 5 minutes - After drinking alcohol, it takes about 5 minutes to reach the brain and all other parts of the body, as it is absorbed into the blood stream, it quickly moves into the body.

Carbonated alcoholic drinks are more effective - A drink that contains a high CO₂ content gets into the blood stream quicker than one with low or no CO₂. That's why Champagne gets a party 'off' with a swing'.

Set yourself a reasonable 'maximum' target amount - Do not exceed it. Also decide on how much time you intend to drink for.

Food helps - Don't forget to eat something substantial to absorb the alcohol.

And always remember, it is a bad practice to drink alcohol whilst working. If you feel you are drinking too much, don't be afraid to seek help.



Techniques to prevent over-consumption.

- ◆ Drink water or soft drinks as a substitute for every other alcoholic drink.
- ◆ Pace yourself. Slow down and take sips, not big gulps.
- ◆ Don't drink on an 'empty stomach'; eat something before going out drinking. Food allows the body to absorb alcohol more slowly.
- ◆ Be careful of cocktails as they may be stronger than you think.
- ◆ Learn how to refuse a drink. You don't have to take one just because it's offered or take part in rounds you don't want. Similarly, don't pressure others into drinking.
- ◆ Darker drinks like red wine, brandy and whiskey usually result in worse 'hangovers' because of higher concentrations of chemicals called congeners.
- ◆ Avoid "top ups", so you can keep track of how much you are drinking.
- ◆ As a barman you will already know the strengths of drinks - keep to your limits: 3-4 units for men, 2-3 units per day for women. And do not indulge every day.
- ◆ Watch out for larger measures at home or at a party, compared with standard measures.

The World Health Organization's Global Burden of Disease Study suggests that alcohol is the third most important risk factor, after smoking, and elevated blood pressure. Alcohol abuse risk ranks higher than high cholesterol levels and obesity, and is three times more prevalent than diabetes and five times more than asthma in some countries.

Alcohol related disease is much higher in men than women and its incidence is highest in Europe and the Americas, where it ranges from 8-18% for males and 2-4% for females.

Alcohol and its role in society

In most countries, as alcohol consumption continues to grow, trends in what brand and types of alcohol consumed change, but in many countries, the production/sale of alcohol is a very important part of the economy, as the taxes and Government levies on alcohol can be substantial.

The attitude of Governments towards alcohol does vary from country to country. In some Middle Eastern countries there is a total ban on all alcohol whilst in other countries, there are little or no controls at all.

Most countries, however, do have some form of legislation to control the production, distribution, sale and consumption of alcohol.

Strict laws for example exist in Scandinavia, i.e. Norway, Sweden and Finland, where the import and sale of all alcohol is very closely controlled and also very heavily taxed, coupled with severe penalties for drink-related driving offences. The US and Canada are also fairly strict, but the UK, Italy, and France are noticeably less strict. Some Mediterranean countries are fairly lax.

In some cultures, the consumption of alcohol is closely associated with many social activities, such as holidays, dining out, entertainment, and business and of course celebrations. It provides for most consumers a great deal of pleasure and causes little or no harm, however there is a small minority (small in percentage terms but large in number) that does have problems directly linked to its drinking habits.

Bartenders are at least 10 times more likely to develop an alcohol related problem than the 'average' person.

In some cases, drinking guidelines are incorporated into general nutritional guidelines or into a national drug strategy. In other instances, they stand alone as guidelines on alcohol consumption. Information included in guidelines offers recommendations on low risk drinking levels for men and women, but may also define a standard drink or unit and offer advice to particular populations deemed to be at increases risk for harm. Pages 36 to 37 give a guide to alcoholic drinks – strength and pouring measures; and also Standard Alcohol Units.

Alcohol is a depressant it is a substance which influences physical, mental and social functions and is not merely a food or fuel, but there is nothing sinister implied in the term. It is high in calories, low in vitamins and protein, and what it is made from and how it is made will be dealt with in a different section. Prolonged over-consumption can lead to dependence.

Alcohol, Lifestyles and Tolerance

Depending on the culture of your country, the amount of the adult population consumption will vary. In some countries it is as high as 90%.

Drinking tends to be associated with good times, like parties, events and celebrations and is often used as a 'social lubricant', for example at the end of a week at work. If consumed in moderation, at the right time and place, alcohol can be compatible with a healthy lifestyle. However, people who tend to drink too much, either binge drinking or over consuming, are at greater risk of developing health or other problems.

Excessive consumption has a corrosive impact in the linings of the stomach and causing gastritis, ulcers, reflux and liver damage. More than 80g (8 units = 100ml) intake at a time is linked with a significant rise in blood pressure, which increases the risk of heart attack or stroke.

Tolerance to alcohol

Humans and animals develop tolerance when their brains adapt to compensate for the disruption caused by alcohol in both their behaviour and their bodily functions. This adaptation is called tolerance.

There are two main types of tolerance - chronic and acute.

Chronic tolerance - This is developed over a long drinking span. Chronic heavy drinkers show few obvious signs of intoxication even at high blood alcohol



concentrations (BAC's). It has been found, for example, that the ability of heavy drinkers to handle normal situations was only reduced by about 1%. Moderate drinkers, on the other hand, were five times more affected when drinking the same amount of alcohol. Sometimes, in moderate drinkers, the effect is incapacitating or can be fatal.

Experience also suggests that tolerance to alcohol is retained for long periods. For instance, alcoholics who have been abstaining for months can return to very high levels of tolerance in a much shorter time than non-alcoholic subjects.

Acute tolerance - Although tolerance alcohol can happen within a single drinking session. This phenomenon is called acute tolerance. It means that alcohol-induced impairment is greater when measured soon after beginning alcohol consumption than when measured later in the drinking session, even if the BAC is the same at both times.

A person with acute tolerance does experience intoxication after alcohol consumption, but may not exhibit all the effects of alcohol consumption. This may prompt the drinker to consume more alcohol.

Acute tolerance to alcohol has important implications for the patron who will drive. For instance, when the BAC is rising, the driver may well feel sufficiently intoxicated to refrain from driving. As the BAC passes its peak and starts to decline, the degree of intoxication may appear (and, in fact, be) much less and self inhibitions about driving may disappear.

In most countries, fixed BAC limits for drivers apply, such a person would still break the law if found to be above this limit, because the laws apply to BACs and not to the degree of instability – e.g. when tested, the person can walk a straight line etc.

Concealing and compensating for the effects of alcohol

Drinkers learn to compensate for the effects of alcohol. If allowed to practice a number of times, intoxicated subjects can conceal their intoxication from a casual observer. It should be remembered, however, that compensation for the effects of alcohol on one function (e.g. speech) may be at the expense of others (e.g. co-ordination) and is unlikely to extend to real life situations.

Myths on sobering up

A lot of stories have been told about drinking without getting drunk, including instant sobering techniques. Here are the fallacies and truths.

Drinking coffee

Coffee contains caffeine which is stimulant and mixing this with alcohol, which is a depressant, can have harmful side effects. MYTH

Drinking water

Although this may help re-hydrate the body this has no effect on getting rid of the alcohol. MYTH

Taking a cold shower, exercising, taking in fresh air in deep breaths.

Alcohol still remains in the body even though it feels refreshing to take a cold shower, exercising or breathing in air outside the premises or elsewhere. MYTH

Vomiting

Vomiting is the body's reaction to poisoning. Whilst it may seem that alcohol is removed, the body has already absorbed the alcohol and inducing vomit does not sober up a person. MYTH

Stop drinking and wait

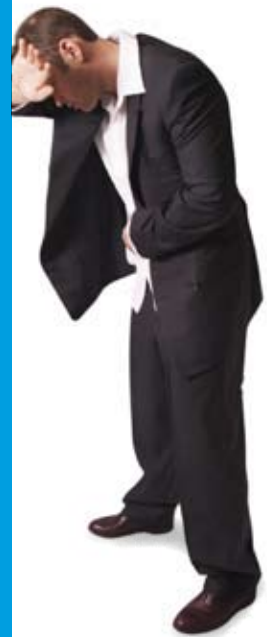
The only real way to sober up is to allow sufficient time for the processing to take place through the body. This could, take longer if food has not been consumed. Normally, it takes around 20 minutes from when one begins drinking, for the liver to start to process alcohol out of the body. The liver then processes this alcohol at a steady rate of around 8 - 10g per hour. TRUTH

Alcohol needs time

Once alcohol is in the bloodstream it is broken down at a constant rate (5-10 g per hour – approx 1 unit), and this process cannot be accelerated.

ABSOLUTE TRUTH

*The best way to avoid drunkenness is to 'pace' oneself - that is drinking at a rate no faster than the body can break down the alcohol. It is important to think about the amount of time it takes to get rid of **ALL** the alcohol in your system, especially if you are drinking or operating machinery, later the same day or even the next day after drinking a significant amount.*



The long term effects of alcohol – Benefits and Harm

In addition to its short-term effects on the body and behaviour, alcohol also has a number of long term consequences.

The effects can be both beneficial and harmful.

Benefits

These are related to moderate drinking over long periods of time.

The heart and cholesterol - Some studies have documented that drinking moderately may have a protective effect on the heart and circulatory system. Especially for middle-aged men, alcohol may help with circulation and reduce the build-up of cholesterol along blood vessel walls, in turn reducing the risk of heart attacks and certain types of stroke.

Osteoporosis and diabetes - For women, especially older women, moderate drinking may help prevent the onset of osteoporosis; the weakening of the bones that often sets in at old age. It has also been shown that moderate drinking can benefit some individuals with certain types of diabetes.

De-stress - Due to its relaxing properties, alcohol contributes to general wellbeing and quality of life. Especially in older people, moderate drinking may make a difference in how they feel and enhance their awareness and sociability.

Harm

The negative long-term effects of alcohol are mostly associated with heavy drinking over long periods of time.

Dependency - People who drink excessively have an increased risk of becoming alcohol-dependent. Heavy drinking may also result in brain damage and harm to the liver.

Despite the possible benefit to the heart from moderate drinking, heavy drinking- especially long-term heavy drinking- may actually damage the heart or increase blood pressure. Some people who drink heavily may risk developing certain types of cancers, in particular of the mouth and throat.

Women who drink heavily during pregnancy risk causing serious damage to their unborn children, including mental retardation and physical defects.

Alcoholic Drinks and their Strength

The strength of alcoholic drinks varies. There is considerable variation amongst different drinks.

For example beer can range from about 2% to about 9% alcohol by volume (abv). In addition, many drinks are mixed with soft drinks or water. In order to make measurement as uniform as possible, the agreed convention for standardising drinks is grams of absolute ethanol.

This means that a “standard” drink will always contain a given amount of absolute ethanol, regardless of whether it is beer, wine or distilled spirits.

Having a “standard” enables servers and consumers to be able to assess the risk levels for consumption.

However, different countries have a different standard drink, ranging from 8g to 13g and certain countries may not have such a thing as a “standard drink”. Therefore, do not assume that each drink, be it a pre-packaged bottle of beer, a standard glass of wine or a measured spirit, to be a standard drink.

The chart allows you to calculate how many units of alcohol are in a drink, if you know the amount of drink in millilitres (ml) and the strength of the drink in alcohol by volume (abv). Both are usually stated somewhere on the label or in the packaging, with abv usually expressed as a percentage.

Strength of Alcohol Chart

Amount of drink (ml) X Strength of drink (abv)% = Unit of Alcohol

1 unit of alcohol is equivalent to 10 millilitres (approx 8 grams)

Standard Drinks	Unit of Alcohol
568 ml of lager (4% ABV)	2.3
275ml bottle of flavoured alcoholic beverage (5%ABV)	1.4
330ml bottle of premium lager (5% ABV)	1.7
Whisky (35ml measure, 40% ABV) and cola	1.4
Vodka or gin (25ml measure, 37.5% ABV) and tonic	9.4
Glass (175ml) of wine (12% ABV)	2.1
Vermouth (50ml measure, 15%ABV) and lemonade	0.75
Cocktails	Unit of Alcohol
Dry Martini cocktail	
7.5cls Gin (= 100mls) @40%ABV	3.0
2 dashes dry Vermouth (=10mls) @18%ABV	0.18
Total	3.18
Mojito	
5cl Bacardi® Superior (= 50mls) @ 40%ABV	2
12 mint leaves	
Half fresh lime	
1 teaspoon caster sugar	
Soda water	
Total	2
Margarita	
2.5cls Silver Tequila (= 25mls) @ 40%ABV	1
2.5cls Fresh Lime Juice (= 25mls)	0.8
2cls Cointreau® (= 20 mls) @ 40%ABV	
Total	1.8
Long Island Iced Tea	
1cl LightRum (=10mls) @ 40%ABV	0.4
1cl Vodka (=10mls) @ 40%ABV	0.4
1cl Gin (=10mls) @ 40%ABV	0.4
1cl Tequila (=10mls) @ 40%ABV	0.4
1cl Cointreau®(=10mls) @ 40%ABV	0.4
2cl Fresh Lime juice	
Total	2
Brandy Alexander	
2.5cl Brandy (=25mls) @ 40%ABV	1
2.5cl White crème de cacao (=25mls) @ 37.2%ABV	0.93
2.5cl fresh double cream	
Total	1.93

Different but Equal



These four drinks all contain an equal amount of alcohol.
So whatever you're drinking, treat them with an equal amount of respect.

It is important that establishments offer a good range of drinks, including some of lower strength or non alcoholic, and in a range of sizes. This enables customers to make an informed choice in order to help stay within healthy guidelines for consumption.

Pouring Measures

So that servers and consumers can keep account of what they are drinking, it is a best practice to use standard measures for pouring drinks.

Pouring measures can differ with varying countries. Pouring measures also differ for what drink is served and the strength of the alcohol.

A standard drink and a standard size glass are not the same thing.

In the UK, wine is sold in glasses of 125ml, 175ml or multiples of them. Spirits are sold in either 25ml or 35ml and multiples of them. A sign has to be displayed stating the size of measure for wine and the spirits, vodka, gin, whisky and rum.

In Australia, a single measure of spirits is 30mls. In New Zealand, 15mls is the norm for a single (although up to 500mls in a drinking vessel can be served).

In other parts of the world, wine is served in a 200ml glass (20 grams of alcohol or the equivalent of 2 standard drinks). Ready to drink spirits (RTD's) or "Alcopops" are usually served in 275ml bottles and cans, so most RTD's will contain 1.5 standard drinks.

Official guidelines on alcohol consumption are generally produced by government bodies, such as the ministry of health or other departments responsible for alcohol issues. Find out what the applicable laws are in your country by contacting your local government department dealing with trading standards or licensing issues.

An international conversion for drinks

The volume contained in the glass or container and how much ethanol is in that volume will enable you to calculate the amount of alcohol is in the drink.

An international standard and conversion for beer, wine and spirits has been determined. The following are equal to one unit each:

- ♦ 1 small beer of 5% abv (200mls)
- ♦ 1 glass of wine of 12% abv (85mls)
- ♦ 1 glass of spirits of abv 40% (25mls)

This international conversion standard:

- ♦ allows servers in bars and restaurants to measure how much they are serving
- ♦ allows customers to know what they are being served; and
- ♦ provides advice to people on how much they are drinking and what the potential effects are likely to be on their health.

Using the international conversion standard for beer, wine and spirits, certain countries have been able to issue official advice and guidelines. Note that the measure varies among countries.

Standard Alcohol Units

Standard drink / unit size (grams of ethanol)	Country
8	United Kingdom
9.9	Netherlands
10	Australia, New Zealand, Poland, Spain
11	Finland
12	Denmark, France, Italy, South Africa
13.6	Canada
14	Portugal, United States
19.75	Japan
20	Austria

Source: Center for Alcohol Policies (ICAP)

International Drinking Guidelines

Government recommendations on drinking levels vary considerably across countries, as do definitions of standard drinks or units.

Recommendations on drinking levels considered “minimum risk” for men and women cover a range of values as daily limits, or as weekly recommendations. In general, values given for men are higher than for women.

Recommendations on Drinking Levels (upper limits)

Country	Recommendations (grams of pure ethanol)	
	Men	Women
Australia	40g/day or 280g/week	20g/day or 140g/week
Czech Republic	24g/day	16g/day
Finland	165g/week	110 g/week
Italy	24-36g/day	12-24g/day
Japan	19.75-39.5g/day	
Netherlands	39g/day	39g/day
New Zealand	60g/day or 210 g/week	40g/day or 140g/week
South Africa	252g/week	168g/week
Sweden	20g/day	20g/day
UK	32g/day or 168g/week	24g/day or 112g/week
US	42g/day or 196g/week	28g/day or 98g/week

Source: Center for Alcohol Policies (ICAP)

Self Assessment Questions:

A. List 8 examples of when not to drink:

- 1 _____
- 2 _____
- 3 _____
- 4 _____
- 5 _____
- 6 _____
- 7 _____
- 8 _____



B. List 5 possible effects of over indulgence.

- 1 _____
- 2 _____
- 3 _____
- 4 _____
- 5 _____

C. What is meant by ACUTE tolerance of alcohol?

D. What are some of the LONG TERM risks associated with alcohol?

E. What is the calculation for finding out the grams of alcohol in a drink?

F. List 8 indicators a customer is intoxicated.





MODULE C

The consumer and other associated problems with alcohol

Topics Covered in this Module

- ♦ Drugs with Alcohol
- ♦ Spiking of Drinks – what, when, how

The dangers of alcohol abuse have been covered in the other modules of this workbook. This module looks at the interactions of alcohol with drugs and how to deal with “spiked” drinks. Any individual that serves alcoholic beverages, or consumes them should be familiar with the content within.

DRUGS WITH ALCOHOL

Consumers of alcoholic beverages should be aware that simultaneous use of alcohol and medications, both prescribed and illicit, can cause adverse effects.

Mixing alcohol with certain medications can cause nausea and vomiting, headaches, drowsiness, fainting, or loss of coordination.

It also can put you at risk of internal bleeding, heart problems, and difficulties in breathing. In addition to these dangers, alcohol can make a medication less effective or even useless, or it may make the medication harmful or toxic to your body.

Some medicines that you might never have suspected can react with alcohol, including many medications which can be purchased “over-the-counter”, that is, without a prescription. Even some herbal remedies can have harmful effects when combined with alcohol.

For example, even very small doses of alcohol probably should not be used with antihistamines and other medications with sedative effects.

Elderly individuals should be especially careful of these potential problems due to their generally greater reliance on multiple medications and age-related changes in physiology.

Many medicines carry warnings not to mix with alcohol.



Alcohol-Medication Interactions

Many medications can interact with alcohol, leading to increased risk of illness, injury, or death. It has been estimated that alcohol-medication interactions may be a factor in at least 25% of all emergency room admissions.

An unknown number of less serious interactions may go unrecognised or unrecorded.

This module highlights some of the most significant alcohol-drug interactions.

(The term “drugs” is used here to refer exclusively to medications, whether prescription or non-prescription, although alcohol can interact with illicit drugs as well)



Alcohol-Drug Interactions are widespread

More than 2,800 prescription drugs are available in the US alone, and physicians write 14 billion prescriptions annually; in addition, approximately 2,000 medications are available without prescription. Approximately 70-80% of the adult population in many countries consume alcohol occasionally, and a high percent drink daily.

As a result, about 60-70% of men and 50-60% of women have experienced one or more adverse alcohol-related life events.

Although persons age 65 and older, consume 25 to 30% of all prescription medications, they are more likely to suffer medication side effects, compared with younger persons, and these effects tend to be more severe with advancing age. Therefore, the elderly may be especially likely to mix drugs and alcohol and are at particular risk.

How Alcohol and Drugs Interact

To exert its desired effect, a drug generally must travel through the bloodstream to the site of action, where it produces some change in an organ or tissue. The drug's effects then diminish as it is processed (metabolised) by enzymes and eliminated from the body.

Alcohol behaves similarly, travelling through the bloodstream, acting upon the brain to cause intoxication, and finally it is metabolised and eliminated, principally by the liver. The extent to which an administered dose of a drug reaches its site of action may be termed its availability. Alcohol can influence the effectiveness of a drug by altering its availability.

Here are four typical alcohol-drug interactions:

1. An acute dose of alcohol (a single drink or several drinks over several hours) may inhibit a person's metabolism of a drug by competing with the drug for the same set of metabolising enzymes. This interaction prolongs and enhances the drug's availability, potentially increasing the patron's risk of experiencing harmful side effects from the drug.
2. Chronic (long-term) alcohol ingestion may activate drug-metabolising enzymes, thus decreasing the drug's availability and diminishing its effects. After these

enzymes have been activated, they remain so even in the absence of alcohol, affecting the metabolism of certain drugs for several weeks after no drinking. Thus, a recently abstinent chronic drinker may need higher doses of medications than those required by non-drinkers to achieve therapeutic levels of certain drugs.

3. Enzymes activated by chronic alcohol consumption can transform certain drugs into toxic chemicals that can damage the liver or other organs.

4. Alcohol can magnify the inhibitory effects of sedative and narcotic drugs at their sites of action in the brain. To add to the complexity of these interactions, some drugs affect the metabolism of alcohol, thus altering its potential for intoxication and the adverse effects associated with alcohol consumption.

Spiking of drinks

This occurs when alcohol or another drug is added to a person's drink (soft drinks, juice, water or alcohol) without their knowledge. Both alcoholic and non-alcoholic drinks can be "spiked", and it can happen at clubs, bars and at parties. Spiked drinks are also called a 'mickey finn' or being 'slipped a mickey'.

Drink spiking has been on the increase over the last few years. A person who has had their drink spiked is put in a position where they may be assaulted, robbed or harmed in some way.

There are over forty drugs that can be used for drink spiking and some of them can have fatal consequences.

The substances used to spike drinks

Alcohol may be used to "spike" a drink either by adding it to a non alcoholic drink or by adding extra amounts to an alcoholic drink.

Gamma-hydroxybutyric acid (GHB) can cause amnesia, impair movement and speech, and can be added to drinks with no visible trace. GHB can cause serious breathing problems.

Depressant drugs, especially sedatives, are usually used to relax the body or help people sleep. Combined with alcohol they can have very strong effects making one feel very drunk and experience temporary loss of memory.

Prescription drugs are frequently used, including benzodiazepines, barbiturates, muscle relaxants and hypnotics-such as Serapax, Valium® and Rohypnol. Rohypnol now has a reputation as being one of the most common prescription drugs used in drink spiking cases.

Illicit drugs such as Ecstasy, LSD, Fantasy, (also known as Liquid Ecstasy or GHB), Ketamine and other party drugs are also used. People appear high or revved up when they have been affected by a party drug.

Note: The victim of a drug-spiked drink cannot sleep off the effects. The victim needs to get medical assistance immediately.

Reasons for spiking drinks

People spike drinks for a number of reasons including the intention to commit sexual assault, rape or to rob the person whose drink they have spiked. Sometimes the only motivation is to see what effect the drug will have on the person.

People have been known to spike their friends' drinks to liven up a party.

Unfortunately these people are unaware of the consequences of what they have done. In all countries, it is considered to be an offence to endanger someone's life, and if the person has a serious reaction to the drug and dies, the person responsible could face a criminal charge for murder.

Where does drink spiking happen?

Most cases of drink spiking happens in nightclubs and pubs. There have also been incidents of drink spiking at private parties, school functions and restaurants.

***Spiked drink victims** - All types of people have become victims of drink spiking, however the majority of victims are young women between the age of fifteen and thirty. It is also occurring more and more within the gay and lesbian communities. One in 5 drink-spiking victims is a man!*

Measures to lower the incidence of drink spiking

- ◆ Do not leave your drink unattended
- ◆ If you need to go somewhere without your drink, make sure you get someone you trust to watch it until you get back
- ◆ Never let someone you don't know buy you a drink
- ◆ When you buy a drink, watch it being poured out
- ◆ Purchase drinks in bottles with lids
- ◆ If you are going on the dance floor, fit the drink bottle into your bag
- ◆ It is best to go out with people you know well and trust
- ◆ Make sure those people know your phone or mobile number
- ◆ If someone goes missing in your group, make sure you look for them, as they may be in a vulnerable position and unable to protect themselves

If someone behaves out of character or seems unusually intoxicated, don't assume they are drunk. They may well have been the victim of spiking. Get them home or seek medical assistance immediately if required. Also, only let them leave with someone trustworthy.

Self Assessment Questions:

A. Name 2 prescription drugs not to be taken with alcohol.

B. Who are most at risk mixing alcohol and drugs?

C. Name 2 of the main drink spiking additives.

D. What would be the main symptoms a customer drinking a spiked drink would experience?





MODULE D

Management, people skills

Topics Covered

- ♦ People skills
- ♦ Management of alcohol service
- ♦ Service attitudes
- ♦ Handling customer complaints

People skills is an art

How many times have you been a customer and something has caused you to feel frustrated? Think back to how you felt when service was slow or when you were ignored....

Many people choose the place they go to purely based on the attitude of the staff and the standard of service they receive. Similarly, you would want your customers to feel they are given the attention, and level of service you expect when you go out, and that the environment is safe and pleasant for them.



**Mr. Nilson Vianna
Candido**
Vice President -
South America

'The New Customer'

In a bar where I've worked for many years, a friend of mine who used to patronise it on a regular basis, came in one day, tipsy. He said to me that this would be the last time that he would be drunk. However, after one week, he returned again to the bar, drunk.

"What's up boy...? You're here in my bar again; drunk?" I asked. "Hadn't you made a promise that you wouldn't be drunk anymore? That you'd wanna change to become another new man?"

Guess what, he replied, "Yes in fact I had, but, unfortunately, I discovered that the new man also drinks too much".



One way to impart “people skills” to staff is to ask them to imagine the various roles required to satisfy the customer:

- ♦ The server should have comprehensive knowledge about the products on offer – **Sales**
- ♦ The premises should be tidy and clean and staff should behave in an orderly way. Otherwise when leaning on the counter the customer might get his/her clothes wet or stained from spillages – **Cleanliness, and Hygiene.**
- ♦ Customers visit premises for the atmosphere and the quality of the staff / levels of service. Knowing what your regulars like and taking an interest in their stories becomes a part of service – **Hosting.**
- ♦ Unused glassware, broken glasses, rubbish on tables, spillages, or bags blocking gangways and fire exits should all be cleared – **Safety, and Hygiene.**
- ♦ Sometimes customers will be refused service or someone may be firmly but politely asked to leave the premises – **Right to refuse as host.**

Anticipation and experience

Seeing potential danger early and hopefully preventing it is always preferable to allowing a situation to get out of hand. Depending on the layout of your place of work, you may be able to see the whole of your premises from behind the bar/ counter or you may have to work with your colleagues as a team and ensure checks of the premises are performed regularly.

‘Exemplary Customer Service’

Some years ago, I was hosting a small, but selective international group in Amsterdam, my home town.

When we were well on our way for dinner, at some point, an Irish gentleman in the group, spotted an Irish bar (known to have a great reputation for fine and distinct service), right in the centre of Amsterdam. He could hardly resist checking out an Irish bar, somewhere else in the world but Ireland, so he convinced the group, who then felt happy to join him.

By entering the bar, somebody suggested having Black Velvet as pre-dinner drinks, Black Velvet being this voluptuousness mix of Irish stout and champagne. The bartender, a fine, young Irishman, apologised, saying there was no champagne available at the premises, however he could mix a concoction of Irish stout and cider, a mix he referred to as “a poor man’s Black Velvet”.

That seemed to be an appropriate solution, but somebody in the group preferred to go for the real thing, insisting on Black Velvet, based on champagne. The bartender did not hesitate for a moment, left the (busy) bar in the hands of a co-worker, told us he would go out for ten minutes and get the champagne. He left us all amazed, because he could be seen jumping on his bicycle (so typically Dutch), only to return within a couple of minutes with a bottle of champagne. Up to this day, we still do not know where he went to, to carry out this mission so successfully.

My party was impressed and so was I. Irrefutably, this action was one of the finest examples on customer service anyone in the group had ever seen. Through my years of being behind bars, this little story stayed in my mind forever and served as an inspiration, always. Customer service basically comes down to giving people the best possible service ever. It is as simple as that. Being a bartender is not just a job, it is a lifestyle, a way of life for that matter, a commitment, a philosophy and a belief, but always, always more than just a job. And in the end it is about caring for and loving people and about positive contribution to our planet. I want to make sure that the service I give to my guests and the cocktails that I shake for them are exactly what they want, or even better. And from the movie “Cocktail” one thing never left my mind. No, it was none of the great flair-tending that was performed, it was the quote:

“The bartender is the aristocrat of the working class”.

Of course, being a bartender is hard work, making late hours and early mornings. But bartenders make the difference to the customer, in the end. Because they have the skills, the personality and the aristocratic approach.



Mr. Ron Busman
Vice President - Europe

Management of alcohol service

Provision of adequate training ensures that the server is skilful. Not only that, professional servers are able to work as part of a team to provide an efficient service, which makes customers feel noticed and welcome.

Ultimately, the professionalism contributes to the good standards of a premises and the right atmosphere – Geniality is desired, bad behaviour is not tolerated.

Servers will have to enforce their legal responsibilities as well as think about social responsibilities.

In refusal of service or in conflict situations, you will need a lot of patience. By getting more experienced servers to share their experience and the less experienced to observe, you are on track towards achieving a professional level of service.

Here are two exercises designed to get the more experienced server to discuss and share with the less experienced server. As a manager, you can also use these exercises train staff to use the appropriate means for various actions they need to take.

Write down 3 key phrases you can use when refusing service to someone who is under-aged.

Write down 3 key phrases you can use when refusing service to someone who is drunk.



Mr. Alex Beaumont
Vice President -
Southern Hemisphere

‘Unexpected Sponsor’

About 10 years ago, the Bar where I’m working, was very busy and was packed with people all night, many who had come from the Saturday races. And at the end of the night, whilst clearing up the lounge, I came across a raincoat, which had fallen behind one of the lounges. By this time, the bar was already empty as everyone had left. Looking through the coat to find some means of identification, I came across a very heavy wallet in one of the pockets. Upon opening it, I saw a very large amount of money, which later turned out to be \$7500, the result of a good day at the races.

I found the identity of the owner who turned out to be an executive of a well known car dealership and immediately informed him that I had found his coat. As it had gone past 2.00am, and we were closed the next day which happened to be a Sunday, I then arranged to deliver the coat to him.

For my troubles, I received a very handsome reward, but more importantly, we became good friends, his company became a regular sponsor of the Bartenders’ competitions that we organised yearly. The relationship and the sponsorship continue to this day.

Bar Service Management Checklist

- ◆ Set up an incident record book, make sure you and your staff know where it is kept
- ◆ Record every incident in detail
- ◆ Debrief and reviews incidents with staff
- ◆ Train staff on all aspects of operation which is essential
- ◆ Staff need to understand the responsible serving strategy. All staff should attend training sessions, to ensure consistent standards are used as laws change
- ◆ It is important that staff put into practice what they have learnt during their training
- ◆ Management should clearly state their expectations of staff
- ◆ Staff should be given some authority to make decisions. Staff should know they have the backing of management
- ◆ Consider how to support good decisions made by staff. With this support, staff will be more comfortable with the strategy for the Social Responsibility of Serving Alcohol
- ◆ A clearly written house policy is essential
- ◆ Regular staff meetings are important



Ideas Bank

Consider having a safe transport strategy. Staff can offer to call a friend or family of a customer. Staff can offer to call a taxi.

Making a phone available along with the phone numbers of taxi companies.

'The Perfect Customer'

The only thing that came to my memory is one about a nice customer that I will call it "My sweet Fisherman".

This is dated a few years back when I was working in a Restaurant called THE PRINCESS LOUISE. I must add the fact that this Restaurant is very successful, as its return on investment occurred in just 6 months.

This is how it goes: On this particular night, a young man came to my bar and requested for a drink which I was very happy to serve. When we started up a conversation, he told me he was a fisherman. So the conversation went on and on for about an hour, and at the end he asked me, "Jose, do you like fish?" and I replied "Yes, of course!" And guess what? About 15 minutes later he returned to my bar to give me a tip, and to the surprise of everyone in the bar, he slammed on the bar a fish as big as himself (about 2.5 meters)! Needless to say, everybody left the bar and there leaving the humongous fish on the bar and that was my TIP.

Monitoring the situation

Monitor the alcohol consumption of customers or groups of customers. Little problems, not dealt with, become big problems. Here are some things that all servers should keep in the back of their mind when working:

- ♦ the types of drinks ordered
- ♦ who is doing the ordering
- ♦ how fast is the consumption
- ♦ is everyone at the table drinking
- ♦ are there people on the table who could give you support
- ♦ is food being eaten?

Remember that it will take up to 20-30 minutes for alcohol to have an effect. If the customer is already intoxicated, another 30 minutes might find them in a bad state.



Mr. Jose Ancona
Vice President -
North America



How to refuse service in a difficult situation.

Here is a system you can use to handle the situation with sensitivity and tact.

Use the steps of T-A-K-E C-A-R-E

- ◆ Tell early
- ◆ Avoid put-downs
- ◆ Keep calm
- ◆ Ever courteous
- ◆ Clarify refusal
- ◆ Alternatives
- ◆ Report
- ◆ Echo

Tell Early - If the situation has been monitored properly, and the early signs of intoxication recognised, then this is the time to act. Slowing service, suggesting food, a quiet word of warning can prevent little problems growing into big problems. Try getting a more sober member in the group to warn the offending person.

Avoid put-downs - Don't be judgemental. Don't say things like "you're drunk" or "you've had too much to drink" ' Don't scold the customer, try to agree with them where possible "I agree you're not drunk, if you were I'd have to ask you to leave. I'm trying to prevent that."

Keep calm - Your tone of voice is very important. You need to have a firm voice without being aggressive. Never raise your voice. Behaviour breeds behaviour. You can calm them down if you remain calm yourself.

Ever courteous - Customer service demands that staff respect their customers. Be polite. Tell it from your point of view: "I'm sorry; if I served you another drink I'd be breaking the law." "I'm sorry, if I served you another drink I could lose my job." "I'm concerned about your safety."

Clarify refusal - Explain why service is being refused. Remember to focus on the behaviour, not the individual. Sometimes a customer may think they are being barred from premises. Explain that they are welcome back tomorrow, if they behave.

Alternatives - Offer them a way to back out with their dignity intact. A warning that this will be the last drink for a while may allow them to "save face" in front of their friends. Offer to call a taxi. Switch customers to low or non-alcoholic drinks.

Report - Make sure that other staff, and other shifts are aware of what has happened. Record the incident in the incident record book. If the customer injures himself, or a third party, after leaving the premises, the record may assist in any civil action later brought.

Echo - If the customer is a regular, staff can quietly reinforce the message when they return. They will usually be in a more receptive state to hear and understand why the action was taken. The customer may even thank staff for looking after them.

Service Attitudes

You are a representative - Anyone behind the bar represents the establishment, its owner(s) or management.

Are you genuinely pleased to see customers and to serve them - Would you like to be served by someone who looks miserable? The answer is certainly NO! If you are not feeling too happy or ill, please re-adjust your attitude. Smile! Think of the good times. If you cannot, it may be time to take time off.

Greet customers as they arrive – Patrons may have had ‘bad days’ as well and need to be cheered up; that is part of the bar service. In daily dealings, good communication skills in a bar are essential. When a new customer comes into your bar, greet them in a friendly way. How you react with your customers will very much depend on the standard of the bar in which you are working. The greeting: “Hello, can I help you?”, may be rather too formal and may not suit the bar in which you work. “Good afternoon ladies/ gents, can I get you a drink?” is a little more relaxed.

If you’re busy at that moment, give a smile or say a few words to reassure the new arrivals that they have been noticed. Apologise if customers have been kept waiting. Inform them when there will be delays.

Accept cultural differences - People from different countries may have different ways of ordering. You must accept their way and be able to satisfy their request. They may like to have a drink from their country and you must know if it is kept in your bar. Some customers have peculiar drinking habits which you must remember. And this is a part of your professionalism in dealing with your customers.

Learn to read your customers - As customers approach, you must try to ‘read’ them from non-verbal cues – For example, one will be getting some money from a pocket, another looking around for the best place to be served - that is your cue to get to him or her as quickly as possible, to make things easier.

Take an interest in what customers order - Make suggestions where appropriate. Tell them about the drinks. Remember what regular customers like to eat and drink, and any favourites. Even if they always have the same, confirm the order. Customers are allowed to change their mind!

Choose the style of service that fits - Dealing with people in a public bar requires a laid back approach and allows you to show your own individuality in relating to your customers. However, in a more upmarket environment, tact, diplomacy and sensitivity are required.

Regardless of how relaxed your bar is, you must always keep a professional reserve - Learn to know when to talk and when to keep quiet, be friendly but not too familiar and never make personal remarks. It is a protective measure, to keep a respectable distance between you and your customers.

Tip on handling a difficult situation

- *Never touch the customer (this is considered an assault)*
- *Speak to the customer away from others (makes it more personal)*
- *If you are inexperienced, don't be afraid to ask for help.*



Participate only if asked - In bars, restaurants and function areas you will inevitably overhear customers' conversations. No one likes intrusive bartenders so don't join in the conversation unless you're invited.

Listen attentively, observe and ask appropriate questions - You can learn a lot about your customer's needs by listening, but you must store such information in your memory until there is a suitable time to say something to them – it could be in the future, when they next visit. By observing, listening and asking appropriate questions you will build up knowledge of your customers so that you can provide those little extras which make them want to come back and be looked after by you.

Question only to break the ice, not for your curiosity - Friendly questions can break the ice and show the customer you care about them. You should ask your customers very general (non-prying) questions as part of the welcoming and settling down process. In this way, the customers will feel more relaxed and receptive to your suggestions.

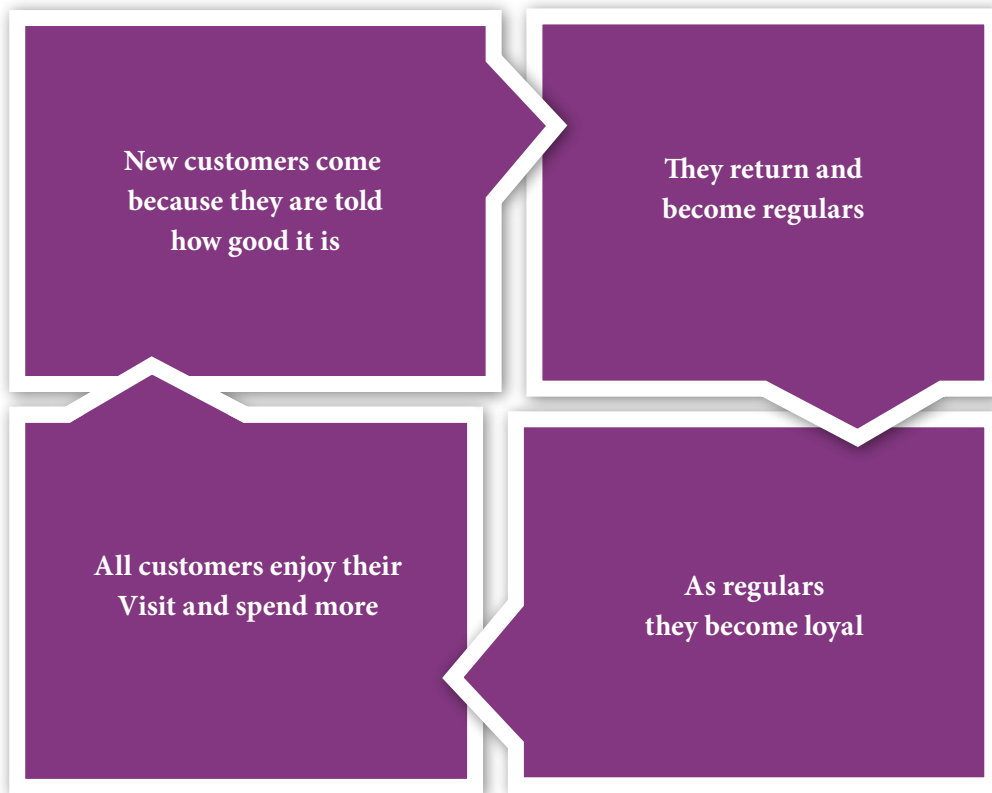
Be a good host, treat customers like guests in your home - In a bar where people are in a hurry, or thirsty, you must avoid favouritism. Work up and down your bar in a methodical way, serving customers in turn. However, offer to move chairs or carry drinks when you can see that customers are having difficulty.

Service Personnel are important too

As a server of liquor, you are important to your customers and to the success of your bar, because of the contribution you make in the following ways:

- ♦ You make the initial customer contact, create an impression that influences the customers on how they feel about the whole place (first impressions count).
- ♦ You can provide the customer with information and help concerning the drinks/ wine, menu and knowledge of the local area
- ♦ You can make the customer feel welcome and relaxed in what may first appear to them an unfamiliar environment (especially overseas visitors)
- ♦ You can help your work-mates, so they can also improve customer service and hence the reputation of the establishment

THE CUSTOMER CIRCLE



Handling Customer Complaints

When you are face-to-face with a dissatisfied customer, try to put aside any feeling of anger, or hurt, or embarrassment. Deal with the situation calmly and professionally.

Don't wait for the customer to actually use the word 'complain' or 'complaint' before acting. You can recognise dissatisfaction from the general behaviour of customers, the words they use, the expressions on their face and their body language (E.g. tapping the bar impatiently).

Dealt with well, unhappy customers can become your best customers. Instead of remembering the worst, staying away and telling others of their bad experiences – these are some of the main dangers if the complaint is not properly acted upon.

Many workplaces have a complaints procedure and rules limiting the action you can take,

So

- ◆ Listen to the complaint without interruption.
- ◆ Show that you are listening with focus
- ◆ Offer to help sort the problem out
- ◆ Report back on your results

A complaint is an opportunity to turn customer dissatisfaction into satisfaction. When dealing with a complaint, we are looking to control the conversation with the customer and to empathise, not sympathise.

By presenting you with a complaint, a customer wants you to know they are upset, what has upset them, and what is to be done.

Given this, we should always:

- ♦ pay attention
- ♦ make no assumptions
- ♦ listen to all information (filter out the emotion)
- ♦ acknowledge, respond and inform
- ♦ never defend, make excuses or ignore the customer's point of view.

Then you could:

- ♦ Apologise properly and sincerely, but do not admit that you or the bar is at fault.
- ♦ Do not make excuses or blame anyone else.
- ♦ Never argue or disagree. React as if the customers are right, even when you believe otherwise.
- ♦ Keep calm and remain polite.
- ♦ If appropriate, and it is the procedure in your workplace, offer a replacement (e.g. if the complaint was about a drink).
- ♦ Where you do provide a replacement or alternative, do so quickly, with another apology for the inconvenience.
- ♦ Check later that the new drink is satisfactory.
- ♦ Complete the special order or form, to avoid problems with stock or cash control.
- ♦ Never offer something you cannot provide - consider what would happen if the customer accepts your suggestion of another drink, but you find the bar have run out.
- ♦ Thank the customer for bringing the matter to your attention - said with feeling, this will show the customer that you are genuine in your efforts to put things right.

The customer incident

From time to time, things go wrong and customers are directly involved. Perhaps they have seen what has happened, or they may have caused the problem, or it involves their property. Any of this is considered to be a 'customer incident'.

There are four types of incidents:

Spillages - a drink or food is spilled by a customer, by you or by one of your colleagues, e.g., at the self-service counter, at the customer's table, or when carrying food or drink on a tray through a customer area.

Breakages - from a dropped plate, cup, glass, bottle, etc., or an accident near a window or in the toilets

Lost property - a customer claims to have left behind a bag, briefcase, coat, umbrella, etc.

Equipment faults - equipment provided for the customers' use or comfort does not work properly, e.g., a vending machine takes the money but fails to deliver the paid-for items, or the hand drier in a toilet is not working.

Establishing priorities

When an incident occurs, you may find yourself in the centre of a mini-drama, especially if people are upset. Establish a priority.

1. Wipe up the spill or breakage, call your manager, move the customers, or get another drink?
2. Pay attention to safety. Carefully remove or clear away broken glass, china etc. which might cause a cut, wipe up liquid spills which might cause people to slip and fall, turn off and isolate equipment which might injure people.
3. Work towards the comfort and convenience of the customer. Tidy up the area affected by the breakage or spill, offer paper towels so spills on customer's clothes can be dried, move the customers to another table, get the details of lost property and ask the customer to be seated while you check.
4. Get things back to normal by bringing another drink.

After things are back to normal, record the incident.

How to report a customer incident

You may be asked to make a record of what happened:

Important information would be:

- ♦ the date and time,
- ♦ names of people involved
- ♦ description of the incident
- ♦ what action was taken,
- ♦ and by whom
- ♦ any follow-up action required, e.g. to arrange repair of faulty equipment.

A system for recording incidents helps deal with claims for compensation and investigations into the cause of accidents or injury.

Note

Some incidents are set up, to distract staff and management while money or valuables are stolen. To avoid this, one person of the staff must keep an eye on the goings on.

Others may have witnessed the set up and could later come to your assistance. If not, let your manager know as soon as you have dealt with the immediate problem at hand.



Management Initiatives

Customers form a positive impression of your bar when you treat them well. As customers are individuals, the same approaches do not work for everyone. With experience, you will become expert at choosing what you say and to the circumstances and the person, so that most customers are pleased most of the time.

Managers can make decisions as:

- ♦ offering complimentary service, or making an allowance on their bill - because the incident was not their fault, or if it was, as a gesture of goodwill
- ♦ depending on genuineness of the claim regarding property left behind, or money lost in the vending machine, offer some kind of compensation / arrange for insurance to cover incidences
- ♦ paying for dry cleaning of a customer's clothes.

Self Assessment Questions:

A. Name 3 important roles you have to assume in responsible beverage service.

B. Name 3 important details to be included in a safe transport strategy.

C. What is the meaning of T-A-K-E C-A-R-E

T_____ A_____ K_____ E_____

C_____ A_____ R_____ E_____

D. List 6 important aspects to complaint handling.



MODULE E:

Policy

Topics covered in this module:

- ♦ Alcohol as a premium product
- ♦ Combining sales and social responsibility
- ♦ Developing policy, role of the community
- ♦ Creating the right atmosphere
- ♦ The Law and You

Alcohol as a premium product

The multitude of ways in which alcohol is used reflects the variety of roles drinking has across societies. Much of alcohol is consumed in homes. Yet drinking is also an integral part of social interaction in many cultures and, consequently, much of it also occurs in public settings and commercial venues.

Drinking venues and drinking patterns are closely related and there is evidence, for example, that certain drinking settings are associated with an increased risk of violence.

In some developing countries, traditional establishments, such as bars or taverns, are venues where beverages are sold and consumed. A focus on the ideal drinking environment with consideration to safety and avoiding violence will promote responsible hospitality.

Responsible hospitality means creating safe and comfortable drinking venues whereby the risk for any harm to individuals is minimised, while at the same time the quality of life in the surrounding community is safeguarded.

Policy-wise, responsible hospitality depends on the involvement of those who operate serving establishments, those who enforce the existing laws, and the community as a whole.

Manufacturers and suppliers of alcoholic beverages also have an ethical and responsible part to play in the sale and consumption of their products. For example, many include statements / messages on labels such as “this product should be consumed in moderation” or “this product is not suitable for pregnant women or those trying to conceive”, or “only to be consumed by those of legal age”.

Many alcoholic beverage-companies are multinational and one of their aims is to build ‘brand loyalty’. They can do this if they have a responsible attitude to marketing and selling their products. This is demonstrated through slogans in advertising and marketing campaigns, that are catchy and relate to health considerations, as well as the product.



Bacardi Limited has demonstrated a good example for incorporating responsible messaging into its advertising and education programs. Its message is:

“Enjoy our good taste with your good judgement”

Here are more examples of responsible messaging:

- ♦ ‘Sip Responsibly’ (Grey Goose®)
- ♦ ‘Pace yourself, drink responsibly’ (Jack Daniels® Racing Sponsorship)
- ♦ ‘Start and end things right, drink responsibly’ (Southern Comfort®)
- ♦ ‘Keep your judgement pure, drink responsibly’ (Finlandia® Vodka)
- ♦ ‘Drink it love it know when to stop’ (Virgin® Wines)
- ♦ ‘Live passionately but drink responsibly’. (Bolla® Wines Italy)
- ♦ ‘The best Times are enjoyed responsibly’ (Early Times®)

A Responsible Server’s Guide

Research was carried out in Scotland in 2005 examining the factors associated with alcohol related problems in licensed premises, such as drunkenness and violence. It found that there is a range of factors that may protect against problems in a premise and there is a range of factors which increase them.

No one factor by itself causes or can eliminate violence but having a range of the protective factors and making sure there are as few risk factors as possible means the likelihood of problems is much reduced.

The findings were in line with a number of other studies such as Canada, USA, Australia and New Zealand.

Protective factors:

- ♦ Lack of congestion, not overly crowded
- ♦ Inappropriate persons (e.g. drunken or underage) being refused entry or refused service
- ♦ Good standards of cleanliness and housekeeping
- ♦ Friendly staff
- ♦ Quick and efficient service
- ♦ Calling last orders in plenty of time
- ♦ Managing the exit of patrons
- ♦ Monitoring patrons, including at entry, the bar and the exit
- ♦ Promotion of food (full meals and snacks)
- ♦ Higher percentage of customers sitting
- ♦ Staff trained in responsible service
- ♦ Good range of reasonably priced soft drinks.
- ♦ Good communication between staff

All of the above creates a relaxed, social drinking environment, and in essence, encourages people to behave “in a manner that suits the premises”.

Risk factors:

- ◆ Unsupervised pool tables
- ◆ TV showing aggressive, offensive, sexual or intoxicated images
- ◆ Music which has a lot of offensive words and overly loud
- ◆ Congestion anywhere in the premises
(at the door, bar, stairs, toilets, dance floor, etc.)
- ◆ Higher percentage of customers standing
- ◆ Drunk or underage persons allowed in and served
- ◆ Vomiting
- ◆ Drug dealing or drug use
- ◆ Drunk customers in the premises
- ◆ Stag & Hens parties
- ◆ Staff being hostile or aggressive towards patrons
- ◆ Staff allowing aggression and conflict
- ◆ Staff sending people outside to fight
- ◆ Late intervention in situations by staff
- ◆ Patrons served double quantities at closing time or being served after closing time
- ◆ Lack of ventilation
- ◆ High level of noise and movement
- ◆ Lack of bar wiping, table clearing, toilet cleanliness
- ◆ In-house promotion or entertainment focusing on alcohol and “inappropriate dancing”
- ◆ Drinking games

Set Standards and Maintain Standards

It can be quite complicated understanding when and to whom you can sell alcohol.

One of the best ways to make this clear to everyone is to create a bar or liquor service policy.

This will inform both customers and staff when alcohol can be sold, who can purchase alcohol, what forms of age identification are acceptable etc.

Combining the role of sales and social responsibility

In urban areas around the world, there has been an increase in late night entertainment activity - bars, pubs, and clubs. While such venues contribute to the local economy and are a major attraction in most cities, the increased activity can lead to social problems.

Mostly, late night entertainment involves drinking, and much of it is geared towards young adults. Noise, rowdy behaviour, littering, and public disorder are not uncommon in some areas, and crime and violence can be an undesirable feature of late-night entertainment.



Generally, these outcomes are linked most closely with heavy drinking patterns, which include binge drinking, intoxication and drunkenness.

Disorder, crime, and public nuisance place a heavy burden on communities and high demand on public services such as policing, street cleaning, emergency services, and public transportation.

Where the density of outlets is high, the problems can be amplified. Since access to such areas also requires transportation, drunk driving, traffic accidents and injuries become topics for concern.

In countries that have an officially mandated purchase age for alcohol, access to serving outlets by those under that age has become yet another issue in need of attention.

Over the years, several strategies have evolved to address the potential for harm and how to reduce it around outlets that serve beverage alcohol. These strategies include:

- ♦ controlling the availability of alcohol through zoning and hours of sale
- ♦ social and education efforts to influence individual behaviour for businesses to modify their marketing strategies, often through peer-to-peer influence
- ♦ policies that address the service of alcohol.

Policies and Educational efforts

Rather than just relying on control measures to influence the availability of alcohol through zoning, hours of sale, and similar measures, certain policies and educational initiatives may enhance the safety of drinking establishments.

Licensing hours - Where bingeing and rapid alcohol consumption are part of the local culture, licensing hours can help reduce the potential for harm by preventing heavy drinking and intoxication that often occur around closing time. The “last call” in pubs and bars often translates into patrons ordering several drinks at once and consuming them rapidly before closing. Extending licensing hours has been effective in some places in avoiding the closing time rush and reducing the incidence of intoxication and related anti-social behaviour and disorder.

Professional Training of Staff - Continued service to intoxicated patrons usually leads to violent incidents within the venue and outside (e.g. driving whilst intoxicated). Liquor service establishments that educate their staff (servers and security personnel) about handling drunk patrons, liability issues, and the importance of server judgment can reduce incidents such as violent behaviour and drink driving. Where minimum legal drinking ages exist, servers and other staff may also be trained to enforce these laws, requesting identification from patrons and refusing service to underage youths or people who are unable to show proper identification.

Value Added Services - The provision of alternate means of transportation for those who may no longer be fit to drive, or incentives for individuals willing to refrain from drinking alcohol and act as “designated drivers” such as free soft drinks, can make drinking establishments safer.

Product quality - Products served in drinking establishments should be of good quality and must not contain toxic substances or other contaminants. This is particularly important in developing countries, where the alcoholic beverage is likely to be traditional (non-commercially produced and not subject to rigorous quality controls), and popular among the poorer segments of society for whom commercial beverages are often unaffordable

Safety Concerns - A key concern around licensed premises is that of personal safety, especially from aggression and violence. Many of the elements like noise, lighting level, and avoiding crowding can significantly reduce the potential for aggressive behaviour. Here are some suggestions on how to achieve a safe environment

- ♦ remove immediately potentially harmful objects, such as broken glass
- ♦ replace conventional glass with more durable safety glass issue “smart” beer mats and coasters with advice for ensuring safety, particularly for women
- ♦ specially design beer mats that can be used to cover glasses and prevent drinks from being spiked with drugs
- ♦ encourage entertainment such as live music, games, and dancing;
- ♦ stagger closing times in areas of high concentrations of liquor establishments
- ♦ limit the number of guests in an establishment
- ♦ encourage diversity among patrons and within parties.

Developing Policy and the role of the community

The desire to provide venues for socialising needs to be balanced against the need to ensure a safe environment, clean streets, and low rates of crime and public disturbance. This balance of commercial and social freedoms on the one hand, and safety and wellbeing on the other, presents a challenge to policy makers.

In developing policy, it is essential that the sale and consumption of alcohol are not seen in isolation, but as part of a broader policy and the social fabric as a whole. In addition, any regulation needs to be framed in social rather than economic terms.

Flexible - Effective licensing laws should not unduly restrict the freedom of adults to socialise with alcohol beverages and should be flexible enough to respond to any changes in the social conditions and local requirements.

Easy to Understand - Laws that are easy to understand and implement are needed, as is their effective enforcement.

Practical to Implement - Make responsible hospitality an integral part of service and a requirement for licensing. Partnerships between the various stakeholders involved in the service of alcohol have shown considerable promise.

The Community

Social responsibility need not only be left to the server, manager of the bar or the establishment where alcohol is served. The community can also play a part. Community intervention programs or “accords” have been tested in a number of places, including countries in Western Europe, as well as in Australia, Canada, and the United States. They can be quite effective when the community takes one or more of the following steps:

- ♦ Work towards a general agreement on simple and easy to understand rules and codes of practice for serving establishments and their patrons;
- ♦ Provision of financial incentives to businesses so that they can achieve compliance with codes and also good practices;
- ♦ Encouragement among retailers, managers, and servers to take responsibility;
- ♦ Education on social and community issues;
- ♦ Implementation of training for servers in intervention, for example, as a requirement for licensing;
- ♦ Formation of alliances with policing and enforcement authorities where intervention is needed;
- ♦ Provision of adequate public transportation and accessibility;
- ♦ Encouragement of dialogue with the community and responsiveness to its needs;
- ♦ Avoidance of the imposition of undue restrictions on the availability of alcohol;
- ♦ Recognition of the role of alcohol in entertainment and within social settings and acknowledging the need to address it within a larger policy context.

Creating the Right Atmosphere

The atmosphere is the general mood, ambience or feeling of a place. This begins to affect the customer from the moment they come in. It can affect the way in which they drink and their behaviour.

Part of creating the right atmosphere is about encouraging people to behave in a manner that is in keeping with the style of your premises.

The right atmosphere depends on various factors – the drink, the drinker and the environment for drinking.

In essence, the right atmosphere depends on the amount and strength of alcohol; the characteristics of the person drinking the alcohol and their state of mind and personal circumstances; and the décor and prevailing rules of the establishment where the drinking is taking place.

Removing or changing any one of these factors will alter the drinking behaviour of your customers. For example, a person’s behaviour at a fine restaurant is likely to be very different from that same person’s behaviour if they were watching football in a bar. The environment has changed, even though exactly the same amount was drunk in both circumstances. Essentially, the environment encompasses the layout of the

premises - whether there are more people sitting or standing, the lighting and the music - all things that create the place where drinking takes place.

The manager and staff are in a position to control or influence at least two of these factors, such as

- ◆ the amount and type of drink served
- ◆ the environment.

Evidence suggests that vertical drinking (i.e. where people stand) promotes more rapid drinking than when people are seated.

The Right Atmosphere:

- ◆ Helps prevent trouble
- ◆ Prevents crime & disorderly conduct
- ◆ Enables the refusal of service to be handled with tact and diplomacy
- ◆ Allows the identification and dealing with potential problems and situations

The Wrong Atmosphere means:

- ◆ Drunk customers are more difficult to deal with
- ◆ More mess to clear up (spillages, breakages, vomit, etc)
- ◆ More disorder, issues will escalate into aggression and violence much more quickly
- ◆ Staff more at risk to harm
- ◆ Increased costs to premises of replacing fixtures and fittings
- ◆ Increased staffing costs - need for more staff to deal with the disorder, with the possibility of a higher staff turnover
- ◆ Premises gets a reputation which in turn attracts more rowdy people and discourages better behaved customers from visiting
- ◆ Extra visits from the police, which puts the licence at risk

Seven aspects – leading to social responsibility

1. *Be aware of the early signs of drunkenness. Discuss with staff what signs detected in a customer would mean saying “no” to serving the customer*
2. *Know what the official recommended alcohol consumption guidelines are for your country*
3. *Calculate how many grams of alcohol there are in 3 or 4 of the most popular drinks regularly served in your establishment*
4. *Find out what the laws in your country with regard to measuring drinks before you serve them. If there are no laws, is there a best practice for your establishment?*
5. *Know the laws in your country with regard to drinking and driving*
6. *Display information, in the way of posters, etc., to discourage drinking and driving.*
7. *Managers should review the range of products stocked and the information about each of them, so that customers can make sensible informed choices.*



The Law and You

Laws respecting the provision of alcohol differ greatly by country, region, province, state, county, village, etc. In certain countries, the barman or server may be held responsible for injury to others that is caused by an intoxicated customer who has been served unlawfully. It is important that you learn which laws apply to you. You can determine the applicable laws by inquiring of the owners of the establishment in which you will be serving alcohol, or by seeking the advice of a qualified attorney.

Damages

When negligence is proven, the court may allow damages. This is the money paid in compensation for loss. It may include medical fees, compensation for loss of income, and pain and suffering.

If more than one party is involved, it will be assessed as to what degree each has contributed towards the loss. The damages will be allocated accordingly. If the plaintiff's own actions have contributed towards the loss, their contributory negligence will be considered as part of the overall damages.

Licensees should ensure that they are appropriately informed about issues relating to duty of care. Advice should be sought from their legal advisers or industry associations.

The IBA and the community

When I began working behind the bar in 1971, there were many protests - from teachers, relatives, friends and even family, against the profession. At that time, I failed to understand their misgivings about being a bartender.

Then I realised that in various media including newspaper reports, there were many negative effects in relation to alcohol, e.g. the accidents involving drunk driving, fighting, shootings, and drugs and so on and so forth - all which happened frequently. Therefore, working as a bartender was being seen as encouraging and reinforcing behaviour and customs that are bad.

In 2000, on my election as a president of the B.A.T., I was determined to address the public misunderstanding about the role of bartenders.

First of all, I called upon charity organizations and participated in their activities unconditionally - offering drinks and free performances but all the while, promoting an accurate perception of drinking.

Very often, we cooperated with the police, to propagate anti-drug activities and also to discourage drink driving. Our initiatives also embraced the idea of wine and health that was frequently advocated by the various Organisations of Rotary International.



Mr Kuo Chao Kun
Vice President -
Far East

We provide courses in bartending for the disadvantaged minority such as those, handicapped of sight, hearing, physical and mental abilities. For juvenile delinquency, a course on creative bartending might involve using coloured water or tea, instead of alcohol. When these teenagers are released, they would have adequate skill, to enter the workforce.

Working with government, B.A.T set up courses for bartenders' license and other related courses in the universities, and high schools.

One of the goals of the B.A.T., when the involvement is with charity or government activities, is to provide cocktails or mocktails. This is because the B.A.T activities are often reported by media (newspapers, TV), thus the general public would gain a better understanding of the role of bartenders.

We have had some results – Parents have begun to accept that their children can learn something about bartending at schools, and allow their children to work in bars to gain experience.

B.A.T would like to take this opportunity to recognise the support from IBA over many years. The government rewards B.A.T every year for its work, and this honour should belong to all members of the IBA.

Self Assessment Questions:

A. List 3 protective factors you could change to reduce problems in your premises.

B. How can community play a part in social responsibility?

C. What are some risk factors?





Appendix A

A List of Specific Interactions

Anaesthetics. Anaesthetics are administered prior to surgery to render a patient unconscious and insensitive to pain. Chronic alcohol consumption increases the dose of propofol (Diprivan®) required to induce loss of consciousness. Chronic alcohol consumption increases the risk of liver damage that may be caused by the anesthetic gases enflurane (Ethrane®) and halothane (Fluothane®).

Antibiotics. Antibiotics are used to treat infectious diseases. In combination with acute alcohol consumption, some antibiotics may cause nausea, vomiting, headache, and possibly convulsions; among these antibiotics are furazolidone (Furoxone), griseofulvin (Grisactin® and others), metronidazole (Flagyl®), and the antimalarial quinacrine (Atabrine). Isoniazid and rifampin are used together to treat tuberculosis, a disease especially problematic among the elderly and among homeless alcoholics. Acute alcohol consumption decreases the availability of isoniazid in the bloodstream, whereas chronic alcohol use decreases the availability of rifampin. In each case, the effectiveness of the medication may be reduced.

Anticoagulants. Warfarin (Coumadin®) is prescribed to retard the blood's ability to clot. Acute alcohol consumption enhances warfarin's availability, increasing the patient's risk for life-threatening hemorrhages. Chronic alcohol consumption reduces warfarin's availability, lessening the patient's protection from the consequences of blood-clotting disorders.

Anti-depressants. Alcoholism and depression are frequently associated, leading to a high potential for alcohol-antidepressant interactions. Alcohol increases the sedative effect of tricyclic antidepressants such as amitriptyline (Elavil® and others), impairing mental skills required for driving. Acute alcohol consumption increases the availability of some tricyclics, potentially increasing their sedative effects; chronic alcohol consumption appears to increase the availability of some tricyclics and to decrease the availability of others. The significance of these interactions is unclear. These chronic effects persist in recovering alcoholics.

A chemical called tyramine, found in some beers and wine, interacts with some anti-depressants, such as monoamine oxidase inhibitors, to produce a dangerous rise in blood pressure. As little as one standard drink may create a risk that this interaction will occur.

Antidiabetic medications. Oral hypoglycemic drugs are prescribed to help lower blood sugar levels in some patients with diabetes. Acute alcohol consumption prolongs, and chronic alcohol consumption decreases, the availability of tolbutamide (Orinase®). Alcohol also interacts with some drugs of this class to produce symptoms of nausea and headache such as those described for metronidazole.

Antihistamines. Drugs such as diphenhydramine (Benadryl® and others) are available without prescription to treat allergic symptoms and insomnia. Alcohol may intensify the sedation caused by some antihistamines. These drugs may cause excessive dizziness and sedation in older persons; the effects of combining alcohol and antihistamines may therefore be especially significant in this group.

Antipsychotic medications. Drugs such as chlorpromazine (Thorazine®) are used to diminish psychotic symptoms such as delusions and hallucinations. Acute alcohol consumption increases the sedative effect of these drugs, resulting in impaired coordination and potentially fatal breathing difficulties. The combination of chronic alcohol ingestion and antipsychotic drugs may result in liver damage.



Anti-seizure medications. These drugs are prescribed mainly to treat epilepsy. Acute alcohol consumption increases the availability of phenytoin (Dilantin®) and the risk of drug-related side effects. Chronic drinking may decrease phenytoin availability, significantly reducing the patient's protection against epileptic seizures, even during a period of abstinence.

Anti-ulcer medications. The commonly prescribed antiulcer medications cimetidine (Tagamet®) and ranitidine (Zantac®) increase the availability of a low dose of alcohol under some circumstances. The clinical significance of this finding is uncertain, since other studies have questioned such interaction at higher doses of alcohol.

Cardiovascular medications. This class of drugs includes a wide variety of medications prescribed to treat ailments of the heart and circulatory system. Acute alcohol consumption interacts with some of these drugs to cause dizziness or fainting upon standing up. These drugs include nitroglycerin, used to treat angina, and reserpine, methyldopa (Aldomet®), hydralazine (Apresoline and others), and guanethidine (Ismelin and others), used to treat high blood pressure. Chronic alcohol consumption decreases the availability of propranolol (Inderal®), used to treat high blood pressure, potentially reducing its therapeutic effect.

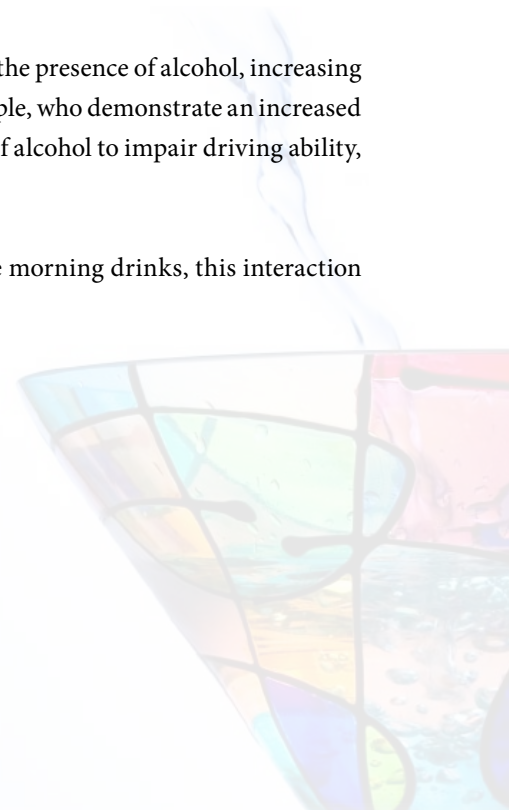
Narcotic pain relievers. These drugs are prescribed for moderate to severe pain. They include the opiates morphine, codeine, propoxyphene (Darvon®), and meperidine (Demerol®). The combination of opiates and alcohol enhances the sedative effect of both substances, increasing the risk of death from overdose. A single dose of alcohol can increase the availability of propoxyphene, potentially increasing its sedative side effects.

Non-narcotic pain relievers. Aspirin and similar non-prescription pain relievers are most commonly used by the elderly. Some of these drugs cause stomach bleeding and inhibit blood from clotting; alcohol can exacerbate these effects. Older persons who mix alcoholic beverages with large doses of aspirin to self-medicate for pain are therefore at particularly high risk for episodes of gastric bleeding. In addition, aspirin may increase the availability of alcohol, heightening the effects of a given dose of alcohol. Chronic alcohol ingestion activates enzymes that transform acetaminophen (Tylenol® and others) into chemicals that can cause liver damage, even when acetaminophen is used in standard therapeutic amounts. These effects may occur with as little as 2.6 grams of acetaminophen in persons consuming widely varying amounts of alcohol.

Sedatives and hypnotics (“sleeping pills”). Benzodiazepines such as diazepam (Valium®) are generally prescribed to treat anxiety and insomnia. Because of their greater safety margin, they have largely replaced the barbiturates, now used mostly in the emergency treatment of convulsions.

Doses of benzodiazepines that are excessively sedating may cause severe drowsiness in the presence of alcohol, increasing the risk of household and automotive accidents. This may be especially true in older people, who demonstrate an increased response to these drugs. Low doses of flurazepam (Dalmane®) interact with low doses of alcohol to impair driving ability, even when alcohol is ingested the morning after taking Dalmane.

Since alcoholics often suffer from anxiety and insomnia, and since many of them take morning drinks, this interaction may be dangerous.



Appendix B

International Drinking Cultures

Alcohol is consumed in nearly all countries of the World and to varying degrees.

A drinking culture is about the way people drink and their attitudes towards drinking. Attitudes differ from country to country. Knowing about the various attitudes enables the server to offer better service

Previous uses of alcohol - Early societies found multiple uses for alcoholic beverages - as nutrition, value, as medicine and to relieve pain. For example 1600 B.C. Egyptian texts contain 100 medical prescriptions calling for the use of alcohol, whilst in China, alcohol was considered an antidote for fatigue.

Throughout its history, alcohol has been used socially for many diverse purposes, such as calming feuds, giving courage in battle, sealing pacts, celebrating festivals, and seducing lovers. Even today, alcohol can reduce as well as stimulate the impulse to engage in aggressive or dangerous activities. It also facilitates peaceful associations and commercial or ceremonial relations.

Patterns of drinking - The places for drinking may vary greatly as do the patterns of drinking, in different parts of the world and among various sub groups and sub cultures within larger societies.

Drinking may be a ceremonial or informal family affair, with or before meals or both. It may be a solitary practice at home, in commercial drinking places or in private hideaways, or it may be a group practice in membership clubs, neighbourhood pubs/taverns beer gardens, pavement cafes or 'skid row' alleys.

Not only one's taste, predilection, or psychological need, but also one's sex, age, residential neighbourhood, education, associations, church and other memberships and socio economic status may determine whether, when what, how much, or with whom one shall drink.

In the United States where nearly one third of adults are abstainers, the better educated and the economically advantage are more likely to be drinkers than the poor- though among the poor who do drink, the proportion of heavy drinkers are higher. By contrast in France, where abstainers are in a very small minority, they are more likely to be found among the better educated and upwardly mobile. The attitudes towards drinking and abstaining, among or within different countries, are as varied as the practices.

The worldwide per capita consumption of distilled spirits, beer and wine has generally increased since 1950, with beer consumption increasing more than the consumption of either wine or spirits. Although the consumption of all alcoholic beverages generally rose during second half of the 20th century.

Europe compared with the rest of the world

According to the World Health Organisation, consumption of alcohol is rising, worldwide, but is rising faster in Europe. Luxembourg has the world's highest consumption rate per head of population aged 15 yrs + at 18 litres of pure alcohol per head per annum.

Other countries with high consumption include, Czech Republic 16.2, Hungary 13.8, Germany 12.7, Austria 12.6, France 12.3 (Latest figures available 2003).

European Countries take up the first 21 places in the league for annual alcohol consumption.

There is a rough divide between countries in the South of Europe and more Northern and Eastern ones.

Getting drunk is frowned upon in Italy and to an extent, in France

In Mediterranean countries like France, Italy and Spain, people tend to drink slightly more than in the North and East. However most alcohol is taken with meals and exhibiting traits of drunkenness is frowned upon. Drunkenness and excessive drinking amongst young adults is lower despite the fact that alcohol will affect and cause problems to a young person more than an older adult).

In both France and Italy, (being largest producers of wine), wine consumption is high, but attitudes as well as patterns and amounts differ in the two countries in many ways.

French parents tend to exhibit strong attitudes, either favourable or negative toward their children's drinking; Italian parents typically introduce their children to wine drinking without any emotional overtones. Italian standards of respectable limits for drinking are lower than those of the French, and the Italians typically regard getting drunk with disdain, while the French look on it with good humour or even in men, as a mark of virility.

Although these generalised patterns are not always consistent among the various regional populations and socio economic groupings of either country, they are thought to be significant in accounting for the much higher mortality and morbidity from alcoholism in France.

Heavy drinking in Scandinavia

Among Scandinavian countries, the alcohol consumption pattern is one of not drinking daily or with meals but rather of very heavy drinking on weekends or special occasions: this is believed to account for the relatively high rate of alcohol-connected problems, such as intoxication, even though the total alcohol consumption there is relatively low.

The Scandinavian countries also have strong temperance (anti alcohol) movements, often supported by government funds, and have large populations that abstain from alcohol consumption. It is probable therefore, that alcohol is consumed by a smaller number of drinkers, than is represented by the drinking age population.

The taxation on alcohol in Scandinavia is also quite high.

The most universal regulation of alcoholic beverages takes the form of labelling and taxation (or in government monopolies, an added profit) and, within limits, price in relation to discretionary income is most effective single method of controlling consumption.

UK & Ireland and their influence on Australia, New Zealand and Canada

In the UK and Ireland, the pub maintains its popularity as a main focus of drinking. In both countries, beer is the most popular alcoholic beverage. The marked preference for beer is seen in other countries that are overwhelmingly settled and influenced by the British populations-Australia, New Zealand and much of Canada. In these countries, the pub tends to dominate the drinking style. Drinking to a moderate grade of intoxication is generally acceptable.

In Northern countries like Germany, Austria, UK, Ireland, Scandinavia, Central and Eastern Countries, overall consumption is slightly lower. However, more people tend to drink to get drunk and being drunk is more acceptable than in southern Europe. More young people get drunk more regularly than in Southern countries.

In Europe, there's a stark divide in the amount of harm caused by alcohol Northern and Eastern countries come off worst in terms of alcohol related health problems, deaths and crime.



The Americas

There has been less systematic research on drinking patterns in Latin America, Africa or Oceania. The limited evidence suggests that people in Latin America drink significantly less than do people in Europe, North America or Oceania. For example, one study found that the total per capita alcohol consumption in Latin America in 1988 was 40% lower than in Eastern Europe and North America and 50% lower than in Europe overall.

However, most research has consisted of occasional reports on special populations, either local or problematic.

One study in Chile found a middle class population that exhibited patterns characteristic of some European populations, including typically consuming a moderate amount, drinking at home with meals, and frowning on drunkenness. The much larger working class customarily drank outside the home, in male company, on weekends or paydays, and sought intoxication that was valued as signalling both friendship and virility.

A third population identified as indigenous, displays a pattern similar to that of the working class.

The favoured drinks in Latin America were generally pisco, which is a strong native brandy and wine. Drinking accompanied secular and religious holidays, as well as the celebrations of births, baptisms, marriages, and funerals, women however, were expected to drink very moderately. Similar drinking patterns were reported from areas in Bolivia and Peru.

North Asia

In Japan, heavy drinking and drunkenness are traditionally permitted in well-delimited social situations and are socially integrative. The traditional beverage is Sake, often called rice wine but more properly referred to as a beer, brewed to a strength of at least 14% and up to 17%. Many drinking customs and rituals involving sake have been connected with religious and social occasions.

Next to sake the common beverage is Shochu, a sake mash distillate that contains about 25% alcohol. There is evidence of heavy drinking and alcoholism, as well as various attempts to impose prohibition. Abstinence was practiced by some followers of Buddhism, and of some revered Japanese philosophers. In the last quarter of the 19th Century, modernisation was accompanied by a 'temperance' (moderation) movement, stimulated, in part by the Woman's Christian Temperance Union, and the Salvation Army.

Since the Second World War, the widespread Americanisation of the Japanese culture has resulted in a growing popularity of beer and an increased use of imported beverages, particularly whisky.

With a population of 47 million in South Korea, where 75% are adults over 15 years of age and 80% of the population lives in urban areas, studies show that the number of those in South Korea who consume alcohol is growing. Koreans drink beer, soju and spirits although they have taken to wine as well. The percentage of drinkers has increased from 55% to 65% during the last decade. The most common drinking occasions in South Korea are social meetings and family gatherings. Happy events and personal stress follow, as reasons to drink. According to the data, drinking occasions at family gatherings increased drastically compared with other social events. At almost all social meetings in Korea alcohol is served and drunk.

Drinking habits have changed slightly in the last 15 years. The "Once or less per month" category increases and "almost every day" category has decreased.

Other countries

India, Mexico and Nigeria are three countries that contain vastly different cultures and distinct drinking practices, report

Drs. Linda A Bennett, Carlos Campillo, C.R. Chandrashekar, and Oye Gureje. For example, overall alcohol consumption is low in India. Conversely, alcohol is an integral part of adult social life in Nigeria. Mexican drinking practices fall between two margins, with high rates of abstinence, particularly among women, but frequent and heavy drinking among people who do consume alcohol. By comparing various cultural drinking practices and attitudes toward alcohol, researchers, clinicians and policy makers will be able to develop more effective prevention and treatment strategies as well as alcohol related policies that are tailored to fit the needs of the particular country.

The United States

Drinking patterns and attitudes in the USA have been studied more systematically and completely than those of any other country. The results indicate there is no pattern or set of attitudes typical of the nation as a whole, instead, there is a variety of patterns, customs and attitudes reflective of the many immigrant and indigenous populations and modified somewhat by changing historical and economic circumstances and political developments. Nevertheless, certain generalisations are possible.

In the post-prohibition and post World War II era, several changes in American drinking practices and attitudes were observed and confirmed by formal studies. The proportion of abstainers declined after World War II, especially among women. By the early 1970's approximately 77% of adult men and 60% of adult women were drinkers. As people aged, abstinence generally increased.

In much of the United States, per capita consumption decreased in the latter part of the 20th century, especially in California and New York, though consumption increased from relatively low levels in most Southern States.

In many countries and societies, alcohol is part of normal life with children being brought up to 'respect' alcoholic beverages. Some societies are abstentionist, such as the Plymouth Brethren, Muslims, the Amish, as well as some Arab countries.

Conclusion

Some countries have strict regulations / laws with regard to the manufacture and sale of alcohol, e.g. who may consume, where they can consume, often the number and location of places of sale, what days and at what times they can consume, and what quantities the alcohol may be sold in, advertising, prices, many use taxation, as a form of control, making it so expensive people can't afford to drink on a regular basis. Other countries have very little taxation as it is an everyday part of society and is consumed at everyday meals, gatherings etc.

It may be part of the culture or religion 'Blood of Christ' in communion.

Some cultures consume alcohol before, during and after a meal.

Countries with traditionally high levels of alcohol consumption (e.g., France, Italy, Portugal, Spain and Switzerland) exhibited stable or only slightly increased per capita consumption. Beer consumptions in traditionally heavy beer drinking countries (e.g., Germany, Belgium, Australia, New Zealand, Ireland, the United Kingdom and Denmark) did not increase as much as did the worldwide pattern.

Wine consumption on a per capita basis actually declined in some countries with traditionally high levels of consumption, (e.g. France and Italy), while it rose in some countries with relatively low wine consumption, especially in the United States, and Australia. In the 1990's alcohol consumption declined in most developed countries, but increased in many developing countries.



With developing countries such as China now having a greater global presence, who knows what will happen in the next decade.

Many factors are believed to have affected these patterns in total alcohol consumption. One factor is the increased use of alcohol, primarily beer and wine with meals, in part result of long term increases in per capita income in many countries and in part a result of fermentation technology that has kept the cost price of some alcoholic beverages relatively low, facilitating the purchase of beer and wine.

Another factor is more sophisticated marketing and advertising, with vast amounts of money being invested into all manner of advertising campaigns, to promote long established and new products alike. An example is the introduction of low calorie beer and wine in the USA in the early 1970's, which lead to an increase in the per capita consumption.

These trends we will see develop and change over the next decade or so and the major influence will be currency, as countries rise and fall on the world economic market.

Appendix C

Effective management checklist to ensure the increased wellbeing of patrons

- ♦ *Cleanliness and maintenance of premises*
- ♦ *Clearly displayed conditions of entry*
- ♦ *Codes of dress*
- ♦ *Adequate quality of ventilation*
- ♦ *Sufficient but subtle lighting and moderate noise level*
- ♦ *Availability of seating*
- ♦ *Crowd control and adequate security measures and personnel*
- ♦ *Limiting size of individual parties*
- ♦ *Ensuring a mix of patrons by age and gender (for example, discouraging all female “hen” and all male “stag” parties)*
- ♦ *Discouraging intoxicated patrons;*
- ♦ *Availability of food and non-alcoholic beverage choices;*
- ♦ *Limiting specials, such as “happy hours,” “two-for-one,” and similar events*

References and Acknowledgements

References:

ICAP (The International Centre for Alcohol Policies)

www.icap.org/Publication/ICAPBlueBook/tabid/148/Default.aspx

General

www.d12.com/Resources/alcohol.htm

Serve-Safe USA

www.servsafe.com

General

www.greenfacts.org/en/alcohol/index.htm

APSAD Australia

www.apsad.org.au

The European Forum for Responsible Drinking

www.efrd.org

Acknowledgements:

Bacardi Limited, Bermuda



A GUIDE TO SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY

